AI-Driven Organizational Change and Employee Motivation in Bank Customer Service.

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ABSTRACT

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Research questions: How do customer service employees in banks perceive AI-driven organizational change, and in what ways do these perceptions shape their motivation?

Purpose: This study aims to investigate the perceptions of customer service employees in banks regarding AI-driven organizational change and how these perceptions influence their work motivation.

Method: This study employed a qualitative, interpretivist design. Data were gathered through semi-structured interviews with 10 customer service employees from Swedish banks, selected through purposive sampling. The gathered data were examined using thematic analysis, primarily influenced by Self-Determination Theory and Sheldon's organizational change theory, while also permitting the emergence of inductive themes.

Conclusion: This study indicates that employees view AI as both helpful and unpredictable. AI has the potential to enhance efficiency, minimize repetitive tasks, and boost motivation when it enhances skills and emphasizes customer-oriented work. However, concerns about accuracy, job security, data privacy, and unclear accountability may lead to feelings of uncertainty. The study concludes that integrating AI into the banking sector should be viewed as an organizational change process that involves both technical and human factors.

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1. INTRODUCTION

The banking sector has undergone several digital transformations in recent years, with artificial intelligence increasingly becoming part of both customer-facing services and internal operations. AI is now used in areas such as fraud detection, risk assessment, customer service chatbots, credit evaluation, automated loan processing, customer relationship management, and operational efficiency (Fares et al., 2023; Kalyani & Gupta, 2023; Yuniawan et al., 2025). These developments show that AI is not only a technical tool, but also part of broader changes in how banking services are delivered and how employees perform their work. Kalyani and Gupta (2023) explain that AI and machine learning are increasingly used in customer-oriented services, credit scoring, and banking operations. Fares et al. (2023) further show that AI has become a growing research and practical area in the banking sector, particularly because banks aim to increase efficiency, improve decision-making, and respond to changing customer expectations.

AI changes the daily work of bank employees. The introduction of AI can shift routine and repetitive tasks from employees to digital systems, while employees are increasingly expected to handle more complex, relational, or judgment-based tasks (Yuniawan et al., 2025). In banking, AI-supported work is increasingly connected to decision-making, customer guidance, problem-solving, and the interpretation of digital information, rather than only manual processing and basic customer support (Blagoev et al., 2022; Fares et al., 2023; Kalyani & Gupta, 2023). Employees are therefore affected not only by whether AI replaces certain tasks, but also by how it changes the content, pace, and expectations of their work. AI can be experienced as a support tool that reduces repetitive work, while also becoming a source of pressure when employees lack the skills, training, or information needed to use it effectively (Molla, 2024; Yuniawan et al., 2025).

Employee motivation is therefore an important issue in this context. Motivation can mean many things, it can be understood as the willingness, energy, and commitment employees bring to their work (Albalush & Devesh, 2023). In a banking context, motivation may be reflected in employees' engagement, job satisfaction, organizational commitment, service effort, and readiness to adapt to changes in their workplace. Motivation is especially important in customer service because the quality of banking service depends not only on technical systems, but also on employees' ability to provide reliable, responsive, and trustworthy service to customers (Albalushi & Devesh, 2023; Kim & Yeo, 2024; Prentice et

al., 2020). Blagoev et al. (2022) specifically connect AI implementation in banks with employees' work motivation, showing that AI and robotization can influence how employees experience their roles and responsibilities. Kim and Yeo (2024) also show that employee-related factors such as job stress, job satisfaction, and organizational commitment are closely related to customer service quality in banking.

AI may also create concerns about future employment, particularly for employees whose work involves routine or clerical tasks. Discussions regarding AI often frame automation as a threat to human roles in banking and financial services, especially when AI is described as capable of replacing tasks previously performed by employees. However, these discussions can overlook how employees themselves interpret and experience AI-driven changes in their daily work, including how changes in roles, responsibilities, and career expectations affect their motivation. Molla (2024) found that many bank employees feared AI-driven job displacement, especially those in routine or clerical roles, while also emphasizing that reskilling and training can reduce such fears. However, job security should not be the main focus alone. It can instead be understood as one part of the broader employee experience of AI-driven change, since employees' responses to AI are also shaped by their perceived risks and benefits, knowledge and awareness, self-confidence, and managerial support (Yuniawan et al., 2025). Employees' motivation may therefore depend on whether they perceive AI as useful, threatening, supportive, stressful, or as an opportunity for development. This is supported by Blagoev et al. (2022), who show that AI and robotization in banks can affect employees' work motivation by changing roles, work conditions, and expectations. Therefore, when discussing AI in banking, it is important to consider both its potential benefits for efficiency and its possible effects on employees' motivation, confidence, engagement, willingness to adapt, daily work, and sense of security (Blagoev et al., 2022; Molla, 2024; Yuniawan et al., 2025).

1.2 BACKGROUND

Banks have traditionally relied on employees to manage customer contact, transactions, documentation, and service support (Albalushi & Devesh, 2023). With the introduction of AI, some of these tasks can be automated or supported by digital systems. For example, AI can help banks detect fraud, process large amounts of data, identify customer needs, support credit decisions, and provide automated customer support (Fares et al., 2023; Kalyani & Gupta, 2023; Yuniawan et al., 2025). This creates

opportunities for faster and more efficient service, but it also changes the expectations placed on employees. Instead of only performing routine service tasks, employees are increasingly expected to work alongside digital systems, interpret AI-supported information, and handle more complex customer needs.

The way employees work can therefore change when AI enters the workplace. In banking, AI may reduce repetitive manual work, such as data handling, basic customer inquiries, and transaction monitoring, while increasing the need for employees to supervise, interpret, and complement digital systems (Blagoev et al., 2022; Kalyani & Gupta, 2023; Molla, 2024). This can have both positive and negative consequences for employees. In a more supportive sense, AI can take over basic administrative tasks, giving employees more time to focus on customer needs and service quality. On the negative side, employees may experience higher pressure to learn new tools, adapt quickly, and remain relevant in a workplace where some tasks are automated (Molla, 2024; Yuniawan et al., 2025). This makes employee readiness, their training, and managerial support important parts of AI implementation in banks.

The role of customer service employees is therefore changing rather than disappearing completely. Research on AI and employee service suggests that AI can improve service processes, but human service still contributes to customer satisfaction and loyalty (Prentice & Nguyen, 2020; Prentice et al., 2020). In banking, this is especially important because customers often deal with sensitive financial matters, and trust is central to the customer relationship. Even when AI improves efficiency, employees are still needed to provide empathy, judgment, problem-solving, and explanation. This means that customer service employees may experience AI both as a useful support tool and as a source of pressure, depending on how it is introduced and how it affects their daily tasks.

Employee perceptions have an essential role in this type of change. According to Adda et al. (2019), employees' perceptions of organizational change are important in the banking business because people do not simply accept change, they interpret. If employees see AI as beneficial, they may be more inclined to use it and more motivated to adapt. Motivation may drop if individuals believe AI to be frightening, ambiguous, or poorly communicated. Yuniawan et al. (2025) also state that employees' willingness to adopt AI in financial services is determined by their knowledge and awareness, self-confidence, perceived risks and advantages, along with managerial support. This demonstrates that successful AI deployment is strongly reliant on organizational support, communication, and employee readiness.

Motivation in banking is closely connected to the quality of the work environment. Albalushi and Devesh (2023) discuss the importance of both financial and non-financial incentives for employee motivation and job performance in banks. While salary and rewards can matter, non-financial factors such as recognition, job security, working conditions, and managerial behavior are also important. Kim and Yeo (2024) further show that job stress and job satisfaction influence organizational commitment and customer service quality among bank employees. Their findings suggest that when employees experience high stress, service quality and commitment may suffer, while stronger organizational commitment can improve service quality. This is important in the AI context because technological change can either reduce stress by removing repetitive work or increase stress by creating uncertainty, learning demands, and pressure to adapt.

The connection between AI and motivation is especially visible in research by Blagoev et al. (2022), who studied bank employees' work motivation in relation to the implementation of AI and robots. Their study suggests that AI implementation can influence motivation by changing job content, task distribution, and the role of employees within bank operations. This supports the idea that AI should not only be studied as a technical innovation, but also as a factor that affects employees' working conditions and attitudes. In customer service roles, where motivation can influence how employees communicate with customers and respond to service challenges, these effects become particularly important.

1.3 PROBLEMATIZATION

Existing discussions of AI-driven organizational change often focus on automation, job displacement, and organizational efficiency, as stated earlier. While these issues are important, they do not fully explain how employees personally experience AI-driven change in their day-to-day work. According to Ahmed et al. (2015) and Kwizera et al. (2019), previous research shows that organizational change can influence employee performance, productivity, and adaptation. However, much of this research focuses on organizational outcomes rather than employees' personal experiences of change. This creates a gap in understanding how employees themselves perceive AI-driven organizational change and how these perceptions may affect their motivation.

The problem is therefore not only whether AI can replace certain tasks, but how employees who continue working alongside AI understand and respond to these changes. If employees experience AI as supportive, it may strengthen confidence, learning, and motivation.

However, if AI is experienced as threatening, unclear, or poorly explained, it may create uncertainty, stress, or resistance. This makes employee motivation an important issue when studying adaptation to, or resistance against, AI-driven organizational change. Therefore, this study focuses on the human aspect of AI-driven organizational change in the banking sector. By focusing on customer service employees, the study aims to understand AI implementation not only as a technological or efficiency-driven process, but also as an organizational change process shaped by employee experience, interpretation, and motivation. This problematization forms the basis for the research question presented in the following section.

1.4 RESEARCH QUESTION

"How do customer service employees in banks perceive AI-driven organizational change, and in what ways do these perceptions shape their motivation?"

1.5 PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The purpose of this study is to investigate how customer service employees in the banking industry view organizational changes prompted by the implementation of AI, and how these views affect their motivation at work. As AI continues to transform work processes and employee roles in the banking sector, this study seeks to offer insights into how customer service staff perceive these changes. By doing so, it underscores the human aspect of technological transformation and enhances our understanding of the impact of organizational change on employees in real-world scenarios.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW / THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.1 INTRODUCTION TO THE LITERATURE REVIEW

This literature review is structured around the article selection presented in Table 4, where the reviewed scientific articles were evaluated according to their relevance to the thesis. Before selecting the final theoretical framework, literature on organizational change, employee reactions, readiness, adaptation, meaning-making, and motivation was reviewed to justify which articles should function as supporting literature and which should form the main theoretical foundation (Oreg et al., 2011; Holt et al., 2007; van den Heuvel et al., 2013; Manninen et al., 2022).

Based on this review, Sheldon's organizational change theory and Self-Determination Theory were chosen as the main theoretical framework because they correspond most directly to the two central dimensions of the research question: AI-driven organizational change and employee motivation (Sheldon, 1980; Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017). The following sections first analyze the supporting scientific articles before explaining why Sheldon's theory and Self-Determination Theory provide the most suitable framework for this thesis.

2.2 EMPLOYEE REACTIONS TO ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE

Oreg et al. (2011) make an important contribution to organizational change research by shifting attention from change as a managerial process to change as an employee experience. Their review shows that employees do not simply receive organizational change; they interpret it cognitively, experience it emotionally, and respond to it behaviorally (Oreg et al., 2011). This perspective is relevant to this study because AI-driven change in banking must be understood not only as a technological implementation, but also as a change that employees interpret in relation to their work roles, responsibilities, and future position.

A central contribution of Oreg et al. (2011) is their classification of employee reactions into affective, cognitive, and behavioural dimensions. Affective reactions refer to employees' emotional responses to change, such as fear, stress, worry, or hope (Oreg et al., 2011). Cognitive reactions refer to how employees evaluate and make sense of the change, meaning whether they see it as useful, threatening, fair, or necessary (Oreg et al., 2011). Behavioural reactions refer to how employees act in relation to the change, such as supporting it, resisting it, participating in it, or withdrawing from it (Oreg et al., 2011).

This framework is useful for the study because customer service employees' perceptions of AI-driven change can involve several reaction dimensions at the same time. Employees may cognitively recognize AI as a tool for efficiency, while effectively experiencing concern about job security, professional responsibility, or the changing value of human service work. Their behavioral responses may also differ from their emotional or cognitive evaluations, as practical adaptation to AI does not necessarily mean that the change is fully accepted or positively experienced. Oreg et al. (2011) therefore help explain why employee perceptions of AI should not be reduced to simple acceptance or rejection, but understood as complex reactions involving evaluation, emotion, and behavior.

Oreg et al. (2011) also show that employee reactions to change are influenced by several surrounding factors, such as individual characteristics, the internal organizational context, the way the change is introduced, the perceived benefits or risks, and the nature of the change itself. This is important in relation to AI-driven change, since employees' responses are shaped not only by the technology, but also by their previous experience, the information they receive from management, concerns about job security, and whether AI is understood as a support for human work or as a threat to it (Blagoev et al., 2022). In this way, Oreg et al. (2011) provide a useful basis for understanding why bank employees can interpret and respond to the same organizational change in different ways.

However, Oreg et al. (2011) are not adopted as the main theoretical framework because their contribution is primarily to systematize and categorize employee reactions to organizational change. Their review is highly relevant for understanding how change recipients may respond affectively, cognitively, and behaviourally to organizational change, and it therefore provides important support for the later interpretation of the empirical findings. Nevertheless, the focus of this study requires a framework that does more than classify reactions. Since the research question examines both AI-driven organizational change and employee motivation, the main framework must explain how organizational changes affect employees' motivational conditions. Oreg et al. (2011) strengthen the analysis of employee reactions, but Sheldon's organizational change theory and Self-Determination Theory provide a more direct theoretical foundation for analyzing the relationship between organizational change, work roles, autonomy, competence, relatedness, and motivation. Therefore, Oreg et al. (2011) are used as supporting literature rather than as the main theoretical framework.

2.3 READINESS FOR ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE BY HOLT

Holt et al. (2007) contribute to the literature by developing a systematic scale for measuring readiness for organizational change. Their article argues that readiness is a multidimensional construct influenced by employees' beliefs about whether they are capable of implementing change, whether the change is appropriate, whether management supports the change, and whether the change is personally beneficial (Holt et al., 2007). This is relevant because AI-driven change in banks depends partly on whether employees feel prepared, supported, and capable of working with AI (Blagoev et al., 2022) .

The first important dimension in Holt et al. (2007) is change-specific efficacy. This refers to whether employees believe they have the ability to implement or adapt to the proposed

change (Holt et al., 2007). The second dimension is appropriateness, which concerns whether employees believe the change is suitable or necessary for the organization (Holt et al., 2007). This is important in AI-driven change because employees may be more willing to engage with AI if they understand why it is introduced and how it improves service quality, efficiency, or customer support. The third dimension is management support, which refers to whether employees believe that leaders are committed to and supportive of the change (Holt et al., 2007). This is relevant because AI implementation can create uncertainty if employees feel that management introduces new technology without enough explanation or training. The fourth dimension is personal valence, which refers to whether employees believe the change can benefit them personally (Holt et al., 2007). This is important because employee motivation may depend on whether AI is experienced as helpful for reducing repetitive tasks, improving work quality, and creating learning opportunities, or the other way around Adda et al., 2019).

Therefore, Holt et al. (2007) is an important supporting literature. The study can help explain why some employees may feel ready for AI-driven change while others may feel uncertain, resistant, or whether employees perceive AI as appropriate, supported, and personally beneficial. However, Holt et al. (2007) are not chosen as the main theoretical framework because their article is mainly designed to develop and validate a quantitative readiness scale. This study is qualitative and focuses on how employees describe, interpret, and make meaning of AI-driven change in their own words.

2.4 CHANGE INFORMATION AND MEANING-MAKING DURING CHANGE

Van den Heuvel et al. (2013) provide another important perspective by focusing on how employees adapt to change over time. The study examines change information and meaning-making as resources that support employee adaptability during organizational change (van den Heuvel et al., 2013). This is useful because AI-driven change can create uncertainty, and employees' motivation may depend on whether they understand why AI is introduced and what it means for their future work role. A key contribution of van den Heuvel et al. (2013) is the argument that employees do not adapt to change automatically. Instead, adaptation is influenced by the resources available to employees, including information that helps them understand the change and meaning-making that helps them interpret the change personally (van den Heuvel et al., 2013; Yuniawan et al., 2025). This is

relevant in banking because AI may be presented by management as a tool for efficiency, while employees may experience it as a change in responsibility, competence requirements, customer interaction, and job security (Blagoev et al., 2022).

Van den Heuvel et al. (2013) show that changing information can trigger meaning-making, which can later support adaptive behaviour. This is important because employees may be more willing to adapt to AI when they receive clear information about how AI will be used, what tasks it will affect, and what support will be available (van den Heuvel et al., 2013). Without clear information, employees may create their own interpretations of AI, which can increase uncertainty or concerns about replacement. However, van den Heuvel et al. (2013) are not selected as the main theoretical framework because their article focuses mainly on adaptation processes and change resources. It explains how employees adapt to change, but it does not fully explain the deeper organizational structure that is being changed. For this thesis, the main theoretical framework needs to explain not only employee adaptation, but also whether AI changes the fit between technology, structure, control systems, and motivation. Therefore, van den Heuvel et al. (2013) are used as supporting literature, especially for discussing how employees interpret AI through information, meaning-making.

2.5 SHELDON'S ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE THEORY: FIT, NORMAL CHANGE, AND PARADIGMATIC CHANGE

Sheldon (1980) provides the main organizational change theory used in this thesis. Sheldon's theory is highly relevant because it explains organizations as systems made up of several connected dimensions, including technology, structure, tasks, control systems, values, and the motivation of organizational members (Sheldon, 1980). This is important because AI in banking does not only introduce a new technical tool. It can also change how work is organized, how tasks are distributed, how employees are monitored, and how employees understand their professional role (Fares et al., 2023). A central concept in Sheldon's theory is organizational fit. Sheldon (1980) argues that organizations depend on fit between their environment and internal dimensions such as technology, structure, motivation, and control systems, as stated earlier. This concept is useful for analyzing AI-driven change because AI can affect several of these dimensions simultaneously. In banking customer service, AI can influence the technology used in daily work, the organization of tasks, and the motivational conditions under which employees perform their roles (Kalyani and Gupta, 2023).

Sheldon’s theory also distinguishes between normal change and paradigmatic change. Normal change refers to smaller adjustments that do not threaten the organization’s main way of working (Sheldon, 1980). In the context of AI in banking, employees may experience AI as normal change if it helps them with documentation, reduces repetitive work, supports information access, or improves efficiency without changing the meaning of their role. In this case, AI may be interpreted as a helpful tool that strengthens existing work rather than replacing it. Paradigmatic change, however, refers to deeper change where several organizational dimensions are affected at the same time (Sheldon, 1980). This is especially relevant for AI-driven change because employees may experience AI as a deeper shift if it changes the meaning of customer service work, reduces human judgment, increases surveillance, or creates uncertainty about whether human employees remain central to banking service. In this case, AI is not only a technical support tool but a possible challenge to the existing organizational paradigm (Sheldon,1960; Kalyani and Gupta, 2023).

Sheldon's (1980) theory offers the organizational change perspective needed in this thesis because it connects change to several internal dimensions, including technology, structure, control, and motivation. This makes it possible to understand organizational change as more than an isolated reaction or adjustment. The following section develops the justification for combining Sheldon's organizational change theory with Self-Determination Theory as the final theoretical framework for discussing the research question.

2.6 SELF-DETERMINATION THEORY

Self-Determination Theory (SDT) clarifies that motivation is influenced by the interaction between individuals and their social surroundings. Instead of viewing motivation purely in terms of its amount, SDT highlights the differences in quality. In organizational settings, this differentiation is important because employees may perform the same tasks for different motivations. Some might engage in their work with a feeling of autonomy and personal significance, while others might do so because of perceived pressure or a sense of duty. Gagné and Deci (2005) indicate that this differentiation is significant since autonomous and controlled types of motivation lead to varying results in performance, well-being, and work attitudes.

In this context, employee motivation is influenced by how well the work environment addresses essential psychological needs. SDT recognizes three fundamental needs: autonomy, competence, and relatedness. Legault (2017) describes autonomy as the desire to feel

independent and in control, competence as the desire to feel capable, and relatedness as the desire to feel a meaningful connection with others. These needs are regarded as universal and critical for healthy motivation and functioning in various situations. When these needs are fulfilled, people are more inclined to experience engagement and autonomous motivation. However, when these needs are hindered, motivation is likely to diminish or become more controlled.

The importance of these needs is emphasized through the motivation continuum proposed by SDT. Gagné and Deci (2005) explain that motivation exists on a spectrum from amotivation, which is marked by an absence of intention to engage in activities, to intrinsic motivation, where actions are undertaken for their inherent enjoyment or fulfillment. Amotivation is an important element of Self-Determination Theory (SDT) and signifies the lowest level on the motivation spectrum, characterized by a lack of intention, direction, or any significant reason for participating in a task. In workplace environments, employees may experience amotivation when they lack clarity about the purpose of a task, feel that they are unable to complete it effectively, or believe that their contributions have little effect on the results. Gagné and Deci (2005) describe amotivation as an absence of intent and drive. Meanwhile, Legault (2017) links it to non-regulation, experiencing feelings of incompetence, a sense of lacking control, and failing to find value in the activity. Amotivation is relevant in this study because employees might withdraw from AI-driven organizational changes if they view AI as ambiguous, untrustworthy, implemented without sufficient clarification, or as undermining their sense of competence and authority. Intermediate levels of extrinsic motivation consist of external regulation, introjected regulation, identified regulation, and integrated regulation. This spectrum illustrates that employees are not simply either motivated or unmotivated, instead, their motivation can range from being more controlled to more autonomous based on their experiences within the work environment (Gagné & Deci, 2005).

External regulation is the lowest level of self-determination among extrinsic motivations, in which actions are influenced by external rewards, demands, or pressures. Introjected regulation is also controlled, but the source of pressure comes from within, often driven by feelings of guilt or the desire to uphold one's self-esteem. Identified regulation displays a higher degree of autonomy, as people recognize the importance of the behavior. In contrast, integrated regulation corresponds even more closely with the individual's overall self-concept. Legault (2017) observes that extrinsic motivation ranges from highly controlled to highly self-determined, contingent on the level of internalization.

Internalization is a key idea in SDT, describing how external expectations, demands, or values are adopted as one's own. Gagné and Deci (2005) argue that internalization is especially important in workplace environments, where people often engage in tasks due to obligation or expectation rather than for pleasure. As behaviors become more deeply internalized, employees' motivation becomes more self-directed. For instance, employees may initially adhere to a new system out of a sense of duty, but eventually they may grasp its significance and incorporate it into their own work.

Autonomy is essential for internalization because it shapes how change is perceived, whether it is self-initiated or imposed. According to Legault (2017), autonomy is the desire to feel independent and self-guided, while Gagné and Deci (2005) explain it as the ability to act with intention and freedom rather than out of obligation. In workplace environments, autonomy is enhanced when employees feel a sense of ownership regarding their actions and understand the reasons for the tasks given to them. Without autonomy, even positive changes may be viewed as controlling instead of helpful.

Competence is also crucial because employees tend to maintain their motivation when they believe they can handle tasks and challenges effectively. Legault (2017) describes competence as the need to feel effective, while Gagné and Deci (2005) link this need to both intrinsic motivation and the acceptance of external demands. When employees are provided with sufficient resources, feedback, and assistance, their sense of competence is strengthened. On the other hand, experiences of confusion, insufficiency, or failure to fulfill expectations are linked to a decrease in motivation.

Relatedness adds a social aspect to SDT by showing that motivation is shaped by how employees perceive the respect and support they receive from others. According to Legault (2017), relatedness is the need to feel meaningfully connected to others. Gagné and Deci (2005) argue that a sense of relatedness is crucial for the process of internalization since individuals are more inclined to embrace values and expectations when they feel a sense of social connection in their surroundings. Therefore, motivation is influenced not just by tasks and systems but also by the nature of relationships within the workplace.

The social context has a crucial role within SDT. According to Manninen et al. (2022), environments that support basic psychological needs foster intrinsic motivation, whereas environments that frustrate these needs are associated with higher levels of external regulation and reduced motivation. The results of their study suggest that positive

environments enhance intrinsic motivation and identified regulation, while decreasing external regulation and motivation (Manninen et al., 2022).

2.7 CHOSEN THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK: INTEGRATING ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE AND SDT-MOTIVATION

Sheldon's organizational change theory and Self-Determination Theory were selected as the main theoretical framework because together they provide the strongest analytical foundation for answering the research question. The research question requires a framework that can explain both how customer service employees perceive AI-driven organizational change and how these perceptions shape motivation. Sheldon (1980) offers the organizational change perspective, while Gagné and Deci (2005) and Legault (2017) provide the motivational perspective. The value of this combination is that it does not treat organizational change and motivation as separate areas, but as connected dimensions of the same workplace experience.

The reviewed supporting literature contributes important concepts, but it does not provide the same level of theoretical integration. Oreg et al. (2011) are useful for understanding employee reactions to change, Holt et al. (2007) are useful for explaining readiness, van den Heuvel et al. (2013) are useful for adaptation and meaning-making, and Manninen et al. (2022) support the importance of need-supportive environments. However, these articles mainly support separate parts of the analysis. The research question requires a framework that can hold the organizational and motivational dimensions together. This is why Sheldon's theory and Self-Determination Theory provide a stronger foundation than the supporting literature.

Sheldon's theory was chosen because it gives the analysis a broader organizational depth. The issue is not only whether employees react positively or negatively to change, but how they understand the change in relation to work roles, responsibility, control, structure, and organizational meaning. Sheldon (1980) is therefore useful because the theory explains organizational change as a shift in the relationship between several internal dimensions, rather than as a single isolated change. This gives the study a stronger foundation for analyzing whether AI-driven change is perceived as a limited adjustment in work practice or as a deeper transformation of the organizational logic of banking work.

Self-Determination Theory was chosen because the motivational part of the research question requires more than a general discussion of employee attitudes. The study needs a theory that explains the quality of motivation, not only the presence or absence of motivation. Gagné and

Deci (2005) provide this through the distinction between autonomous motivation, controlled motivation, and amotivation, while Legault (2017) strengthens the framework through autonomy, competence, and relatedness. This makes SDT suitable for analyzing how employees' perceptions of organizational change become connected to motivation, professional confidence, control, and meaningful work.

The strength of combining Sheldon and SDT is that each theory covers what the other does not fully explain. Sheldon explains the organizational conditions surrounding change, but it does not provide a detailed motivation theory. SDT explains motivation, but it does not provide a full organizational change theory. Together, they create a framework where organizational change can be analyzed through its effects on work systems, responsibility, and control, while motivation can be analyzed through how employees experience autonomy, competence, relatedness, and motivational quality (Sheldon, 1980; Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017).

3. METHODOLOGY

3.1 RESEARCH PHILOSOPHY

This study followed an interpretivist research philosophy because the aim was to understand how customer service employees in the Swedish banking sector personally interpreted AI-driven organizational change and how these interpretations shaped their motivation. Interpretivism was suitable since the study focused on meanings, experiences, perceptions, and the way employees made sense of their social and organizational reality. Chowdhury (2014) explains that interpretivism seeks to understand the social world from the perspective of the people being studied and recognizes that reality is not fixed, but interpreted differently depending on individuals' experiences, contexts, and interactions.

Therefore, this study did not treat employee motivation as something that could only be measured through numerical indicators. Instead, motivation was understood as a subjective experience shaped by how employees perceived AI, their work role, organizational change, and their future position within the bank. Because the research question required deeper insight into employees' own interpretations, the interpretivist approach made it possible to capture the complexity of employee perceptions. It also allowed the study to develop a more detailed understanding of how these perceptions shaped motivation during AI-driven organizational change (Chowdhury, 2014).

3.2 RESEARCH APPROACH

This study used a primarily deductive qualitative approach, while still allowing inductive themes to emerge from the interview data. A deductive approach was appropriate because the study was guided by existing theories, mainly Self-Determination Theory and organizational change theory, together with previous literature on AI, organizational change, and employee motivation. The interview data were then used to explore how these theoretical concepts appeared in the banking context.

The interview questions were therefore not created randomly, but were developed from the research question, the theoretical framework, and current workplace issues such as AI implementation, increasing automation, concerns about unemployment, and the possible effect of these changes on employee motivation. This gave the study a clear theoretical direction and helped connect the interview material to the purpose of the thesis.

At the same time, the study remained open to new meanings from the participants' answers. This was important because employees could raise issues that were not fully expected before the interviews, such as fear of losing human interaction, lack of training, trust or distrust in AI systems, uncertainty about job security, or changes in professional identity. Therefore, the study was mainly deductive because it was guided by theory, but it also included inductive elements. And the inductive elements were secured by avoiding leading participants towards predetermined answers. Instead, participants were allowed to explain their own experiences and interpretations in their own words. This fits thematic analysis, as Joffe (2012) explains that thematic analysis can work with both theory-driven themes and themes that naturally emerge from collected data.

3.3 RESEARCH DESIGN

A qualitative research design was selected because the purpose of the study was to investigate a phenomenon in a real-world setting and to collect narrative data from individuals in order to develop a deeper understanding (Adeoye-Olatunde & Olenik, 2021). Based on the research question, a qualitative design was more suitable than a quantitative survey, since a survey could have shown general patterns but would not have provided the same depth regarding how employees felt motivated, pressured, supported, or uncertain during AI-related change (Hughes & Scholtz, 2019). Additionally, the banking sector includes employees of different ages, experiences, and levels of adaptation to AI systems. Therefore, their experiences were

likely to vary. A qualitative design allowed these differences to be explored in depth rather than reduced to numbers (Joffe, 2012).

3.4 DATA COLLECTION - SEMI-STRUCTURED INTERVIEWS

The study collected data through face-to-face semi-structured interviews conducted at the bank. Semi-structured interviews were suitable because they allowed the researchers to use prepared questions while still maintaining flexibility to ask follow-up questions when participants gave short, unclear, or particularly relevant answers. Adeoye-Olatunde and Olenik (2021) explain that semi-structured interviews are especially useful when the aim is to understand participants' unique perspectives rather than produce only a generalized understanding of any subject.

This method fitted the study because it aimed to understand how employees themselves described AI-driven change and motivation. Although all participants were asked the same main questions in the same order to maintain consistency, the interviews were still semi-structured because the researchers used probing questions and allowed participants to expand, clarify, and introduce new perspectives beyond the prepared interview guide. This was done to maintain consistency across the interviews and to keep the thematic areas clearly separated, rather than allowing discussions about motivation, ethical concerns, or organizational change to overlap too much. At the same time, the structure did not restrict participants to predetermined or expected answers. Instead, participants were allowed to introduce new perspectives; therefore, the interview process combined structure with flexibility, which made it possible to compare responses across participants while still capturing individual experiences in depth.

Table 1: Overview of Interview Themes

Themes	Focus	Number of Questions
Theme 1 (Understanding AI at Work)	Background, Role, Work experience, (Employee's views and comprehension of AI in the workplace.)	5
Theme 2 (AI and Job Roles)	Perception of AI driven organizational change	5
Theme 3 (AI and Motivation)	Motivation, job security, and reaction to change	6
Theme 4 (Concerns and Future Expectations)	Organizational support, adaptation, and future expectation	5

A total of ten bank employees were interviewed, and each interview lasted approximately 20–35 minutes. The interview guide was divided into four themes. Each theme contained three main questions and two additional insightful questions. Theme three contained six questions because it focused directly on motivation, which was the central concept of the research question. The interview guide was divided into four themes because the research question required several connected areas to be explored separately. The first theme established the participants' background, role, work experience, and general understanding of AI. The second theme focused on how employees perceived AI-driven organizational change in their work. The third theme examined motivation, job security, and reactions to change, which was central to the purpose of the study. The fourth theme focused on organizational support, adaptation, and future expectations. Therefore, the four-theme structure was not chosen just because , but was designed to move logically from general experiences of AI to more specific issues of change, motivation, and future adjustment. This helped make the interviews more structured, consistent, and directly connected to the research question.

3.5 SAMPLING / DEVELOPMENT OF THE INTERVIEW GUIDE

The study used purposive sampling, meaning that participants were selected because they were relevant to the research topic. Participants were chosen based on specific inclusion criteria. They had to work in customer service or closely related roles within the Swedish

banking sector, have experience of digital or AI-related changes in their workplace**,** and be able to reflect on how these changes influenced their work role, daily tasks, and motivation. This made the participants relevant to the research question because they had direct experience of the subject being studied, and the participants' ability to provide rich and relevant information about AI-driven organizational change in banking. Adeoye-Olatunde and Olenik (2021) explain that sampling is important in qualitative research because the trustworthiness of the findings depends heavily on whether participants have knowledge of the subject being studied. The participants included both men and women and represented different levels of work experience. This variation was useful because it allowed the study to capture different perspectives on AI-driven organizational change and motivation within the banking sector.

Some topics, such as job security, AI, and motivation, were considered sensitive. Therefore, the interview questions were sent to the CEO of the bank in advance for review and approval before the employees were approached, and the CEO approved them. However, this approval did not replace individual participant consent, as each participant was still informed about the study and participated voluntarily (Appendix 1).

3.6 DATA PREPARATION AND ANALYSIS

The interviews were transcribed and analyzed using thematic analysis. Thematic analysis was suitable because the study aimed to identify patterns of meaning across the participants' answers. Joffe (2012) explains that thematic analysis is used to identify and analyze patterns of meaning within a data set. This made it appropriate for the present thesis because the aim was to identify repeated themes in how bank employees described AI-driven organizational change and its effect on motivation.

The analysis followed a structured process. First, the interview transcripts were read several times to become familiar with the data. Second, important statements were highlighted and coded. According to Adeoye-Olatunde and Olenik (2021), coding involves identifying and labeling relevant parts of the interview data, including topics, similarities, differences, and participant quotes. Third, similar codes were grouped into broader themes. Finally, these themes were reviewed and connected to the research question and theoretical framework (Adeoye-Olatunde & Olenik, 2021).

The thematic analysis included both deductive and inductive elements, as stated earlier. This was suitable because Joffe (2012) argues that thematic analysis can use existing theoretical ideas while also allowing emerging themes from the data to "speak."

3.7 USE OF PARTICIPANT QUOTES

Participant quotes were used in the findings chapter to support the identified themes. The quotes were not used alone, instead, each quote was followed by an interpretation and connected to the research question and theoretical framework. This helped ensure that the findings were not based only on selected statements but were supported by a systematic analytical process (Table 2). The decision to use codes, sub-themes, and main themes was guided by Braun and Clarke's thematic analysis framework. Braun and Clarke (2006) **explain** that thematic analysis is a systematic method for identifying, analyzing, and reporting patterns within qualitative data. In this study, the analysis followed this logic by first reading the interview material, then developing initial codes, grouping similar codes into sub-themes, and finally forming broader main themes. This step-by-step structure helped show how the findings were developed from the participants' own statements rather than from random or unsupported interpretations.

The findings chapter, therefore, followed this structure:

Table 2: Structure of the Findings Analysis

Participant quote →	Thematic coding →	Sub-theme →	Main theme →	Interpretation

This approach is also supported by Ahmed et al. (2025), who explain that thematic analysis commonly follows six phases: familiarisation with the data, generating initial codes, searching for themes, reviewing themes, defining and naming themes, and writing the report.

3.8 CREDIBILITY AND TRUSTWORTHINESS

According to Daniel et al. (2024), the TACT framework can be used as a guiding structure for strengthening rigor in qualitative research through trustworthiness, auditability, credibility, and transferability. Credibility was supported by using a structured interview guide, conducting face-to-face interviews, and asking probing follow-up questions when participants gave short or unclear answers. In addition, participant quotations were used to support the identified themes; however, the quotations were not treated as isolated evidence. Instead,

each selected quotation was interpreted in relation to the research question and theoretical framework and was considered alongside three, and in some cases four, additional participants who expressed either similar or contrasting views. This was presented in the findings tables under the column “Participants expressing similar views,” in every theme. The purpose of this procedure was to show that the main themes were not developed from one participant's perspective alone, but from broader patterns across the dataset. Including both convergent and divergent responses also reduced the risk of confirmation bias, as the analysis did not only focus on statements that supported the expected theoretical ideas.

Trustworthiness and auditability were further strengthened by documenting how the data were collected, transcribed, coded, and developed into themes. This follows the logic of thematic analysis, where researchers move systematically from familiarization with the data to coding, theme development, reviewing, defining, and reporting themes in relation to the research question (Braun & Clarke, 2006; Ahmed et al., 2025). Transferability was supported by clearly describing the banking context, participant profile, interview structure, and analytical process, allowing readers to judge whether the findings may be relevant to similar organizational or banking contexts.

3.9 LITERATURE REVIEW AND ARTICLE RELEVANCE RATING

To make the literature review and theoretical framework more systematic, the articles used in this study were evaluated through an article relevance rating process. This process was inspired by Wu and Crestani (2003), who showed that ranking can be based on clear measures rather than unsupported judgment. In this thesis, the rating system was not used as a statistical tool, but as a transparent way to explain why some articles were treated as core theoretical sources while others were used as supporting literature.

Table 3: Article Relevance Rating Guide

Rating	Meaning	Explanation
3	Core article	The article is highly necessary and directly supports the theoretical framework and main analysis.
2	Strong supporting article	The article is relevant and useful, but it is not the main theoretical foundation.
1	Limited relevance	The article may support a small background point, but it is not central to the thesis.
0	Limited / Not relevant	The article does not clearly support the thesis and only provides a small or unclear connection

However, this rating process also had limitations. The numbers should not be understood as absolute measures of article quality. For example, an article rated 2 is not weak; it is still useful and relevant, but it is not the main theoretical foundation of the thesis. Similarly, an article rated 3 is not automatically better in general, but it is more central to this specific research question and theoretical framework. Therefore, the rating was used to clarify the role of each article in the thesis, rather than to judge the overall academic quality of the sources.

Table 4: Theoretical Framework Article Selection

Article	Main Contribution	Rating	Reasoning for Inclusion
Legault (2017)	Self-Determination Theory	3	Core article because it provides the main motivation theory used to interpret how AI-driven change may influence employees' autonomy, competence, and relatedness.
Sheldon (1980)	Organizational change theory	3	Core article because it provides the main theoretical foundation for understanding AI as part of organizational change, especially how technology affects structure, roles, and work processes.
Oreg et al. (2011)	Employee reaction to change	3	Core article because it explains how employees cognitively and emotionally respond to organizational change, which is central to understanding their perception of AI.
Van den Heuvel et al. (2013)	Change information and meaning-making	2	Strong supporting article because it helps explain how employees interpret change through available information and sense-making, although it is not the primary theory in the study.
Holt et al. (2007)	Readiness for organizational change	2	Strong supporting article because it supports the discussion of employee readiness and willingness to adapt, although the thesis does not apply a quantitative readiness scale.

This relevance rating was important because the study combines several areas AI-driven organizational change, employee perceptions, and motivation in the banking sector. Therefore, the selected literature needed to support both the organizational change perspective and the motivation perspective.

3.10 ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

Ethical considerations were important throughout the study. Before each interview, participants were informed about the purpose of the study, that participation was voluntary, and that they had the right to refuse to answer any question (see Appendix 1). Participants were also informed that the data would only be used in accordance with GDPR and solely for school and study purposes. This followed ethical principles requiring participants to understand the study before taking part and to know that participation was voluntary (Hughes & Scholtz, 2019).

Participants were not forced to state their age. If they chose not to answer, this was accepted without pressure. This was important because demographic information should not be collected in a way that creates discomfort or increases the risk of identification. Confidentiality was also maintained. The names of participants, the specific bank branch, and any identifying details were removed from the thesis. Participants were referred to using codes such as Participant 1 or Participant 2. Adeoye-Olatunde and Olenik (2021) state that participant quotes and demographic information should not include identifiable information and should use non-identifying codes when labeled.

Recordings were only used for transcription and analysis by the research group. The data were not shared outside the study group or used for any purpose beyond the school project. Research ethics also require careful handling of sensitive results, confidentiality, and privacy for both the organization and the participants (Naidoo, 2019). This was especially important in this study because participants could express concerns about AI, motivation, job security, or management support, and these answers should not be traceable back to them.

The researchers also reported the findings honestly. Quotes were not changed in a way that altered participants' meaning, and findings were not invented or exaggerated. Cooper and Dent (2011) argue that ethical research reporting includes avoiding fabrication, correcting errors, avoiding plagiarism, and presenting research results responsibly.

3.11 METHODOLOGICAL LIMITATIONS AND MITIGATION STRATEGIES

One limitation of this study is the sample size. The study includes ten participants, which is suitable for a qualitative thesis, but it does not allow for statistical generalization to all bank employees. However, the aim of this study is not statistical generalization, but analytical

depth. This limitation is therefore mitigated through the use of semi-structured interviews, which allow participants to explain their experiences in detail and provide richer insights into how AI-driven organizational change is perceived and connected to motivation.

Another limitation is that the participants are mainly between their 20s and early 30s (see Appendix 2). This means that the findings may reflect the perceptions of younger bank employees more than those of older employees. Older employees may have different experiences of digitization, job security, and AI-driven change. To address this limitation, the study is transparent about the sample characteristics and avoids making broad claims about all bank employees. Instead, the findings are presented as context-specific insights from the interviewed customer service employees, which clarifies the scope of the study and reduces the risk of overgeneralization.

A third limitation concerns the sensitivity of the topic. Since the interviews were conducted face-to-face in the bank, some participants may have been careful in how openly they spoke about AI, motivation, and organizational change. This limitation was mitigated through ethical and practical measures. Participants were informed about confidentiality, voluntary participation, and their right to skip questions. Identifying details were removed, and participants were coded anonymously. These measures reduce the risk of participants feeling exposed and increase the likelihood of honest responses.

Overall, these strategies do not remove the limitations completely, but they strengthen the credibility, transparency, and methodological defensibility of the study. The limitations are therefore acknowledged and considered when presenting and interpreting the findings.

4. FINDINGS

4.1 INTRODUCTION

A good findings section should present the results clearly, concisely, and objectively, while leaving deeper theoretical interpretation for the discussion chapter (Fox & Jennings, 2014; Snyder et al., 2019). Therefore, this chapter follows that approach by presenting the interview findings through the identified themes, supported by tables and selected participant quotations. Snyder et al. (2019) argue that results should guide the reader logically through the key findings, while Fox and Jennings (2014) explain that results should be presented without unnecessary repetition or premature discussion. In line with this, the findings in this

chapter are structured from participant quotation to code, sub-theme, and main theme, as explained in the methodology chapter.

For qualitative research, participant quotations help show the connection between the raw data and the researcher's interpretation (Corden & Sainsbury, 2006; Adeoye-Olatunde & Olenik, 2021). However, the selected participants are not presented as statistically representative, but as representative examples of strong and recurring ideas across the interview material. This allows the chapter to show the main patterns clearly, while still including contrasting views where participants expressed different experiences (Joffe, 2012; Daniel, 2019)

4.2 THEME 1: AI AS A HELPFUL BUT IMPERFECT WORKPLACE SUPPORT TOOL

As shown in Table 5, the main theme, AI as a helpful but imperfect workplace support tool, was developed from participants' descriptions of AI as both practically useful and operationally limited. The responses showed that AI supported documentation, information access, and work efficiency but could also produce inaccuracies, misunderstand customer interaction, or require human correction. Therefore, the theme reflects a conditional understanding of AI, and it was valued as a support tool but not seen as reliable enough to replace employee judgment.

Participant 1 was central to identifying the imperfect side of the theme. The participants explained that AI had created additional work because the employee had to record the customer meeting, review the AI-generated text, correct inaccuracies, and still complete the logging manually. This response led to the code's double work and inaccuracies, which were grouped under the sub-theme verification burden. Analytically, this shows that AI not only reduced administrative work but also introduced a new responsibility where the employee had to check and correct the system's output before the task could be completed.

Participant 8 further strengthened this interpretation by showing that usefulness and limitation could exist within the same experience. The participant described AI summaries as clear and detailed, which supported the code clarity. However, the same response also showed that AI could misunderstand the meaning of a customer interaction, which has led to the code misinterpretation and the sub-theme clear but imperfect summaries.

The helpful side of the theme was developed through participants who described AI as improving the flow of daily work. Participant 3 explained that AI was valuable because it

summarized customer calls and allowed employees to focus more on the customer's actual errand instead of logging. This response supported the code's efficiency and task support, leading to the sub-theme AI as an efficiency tool. Participant 2 added that AI was useful for newer employees because it helped them manage large amounts of information more easily, while Participant 4 emphasized that AI made work faster by reducing manual writing after customer calls. Together, these responses formed the sub-theme of accessible and practical support, as AI was described as lowering practical barriers and making customer service tasks easier to manage.

Participant 10 added another important layer by describing AI as helpful while also recognizing that the technology was still in an early stage of development. This contribution strengthened the overall theme because it showed that AI was not rejected, but neither was it treated as complete or fully mature. Instead, AI was understood as a useful but developing workplace tool that still required human awareness and control.

For this reason, the final theme was not defined simply as AI as a helpful tool, as this would overlook the verification burden and interpretive risks identified in the data. It was also not framed as AI as an efficiency tool, since efficiency only captured one dimension of participants' responses. The final formulation, AI as a helpful but imperfect workplace support tool, was therefore chosen because it more accurately reflects Table 5. AI supported customer service work, but its value remained dependent on human verification, contextual interpretation, and professional oversight.

Table 5: Theme 1

Participant number (Participants with similar ideas)	Participant Quote	Code/s	Coding rationale	Sub-theme	Main theme
P1 (P2,3,4,7)	"No, I mean, if anything, it's actually added more work." "Because now, first of all, the customer meeting has to be recorded. Then afterward, when you're logging it, you have to read through what the AI has written, and there are often inaccuracies, maybe reference errors or similar, so you have to edit the text to make it correct. And then you still have to log it yourself, so it ends up being double work."	-Double Work -Inaccuracies	Participant 1's quote shows that AI added more work instead of reducing it. The code **double work** was chosen because the employee had to record, read, correct, and still complete the logging. The code **inaccuracies** were chosen because the participant mentioned that the AI text often contained mistakes. This led to the sub-theme, because AI support still required employees to check and correct the output.	Verification burden	AI as a helpful but imperfect workplace support tool
P8 (P2,3,4,6)	"I mean, it is both good and bad. In one way, I think that it becomes clear what we have done, like what has been said during the conversation. The AI makes it very, very clear and you get much more text than what you can write down yourself. So from that aspect I think that it is very good. I can follow up on what the customer talked about with my colleague, what the matter concerned, what they discussed during the conversation and what the outcome was. However, I think that certain things can be missed in the AI's summary. Sometimes it can say that you maybe performed something when you only gave information, so those kinds of things I think the AI does not really understand or comprehend. So it can also make it more confusing."	-Clarity -Misinterpretation	Participant 8's quote shows that AI made customer conversations clearer, but not always fully accurate. The code **clarity** was chosen because AI provided more detailed written summaries than employees could write themselves. The code **misinterpretation** was chosen because AI could misunderstand what actually happened in the customer interaction. This led to the sub-theme, because AI improved documentation but still needed human judgment.	Clear but imperfect summaries	
P3 (P2,4,,6,7)	"I see AI as a valuable tool because it makes work more efficient. For example, it summarizes customer calls, which allows us to focus on the actual errand rather than the logging. The AI handles that now when we assist customers over the phone."	-Efficiency -Task support	Participant 3's quote shows that AI helped make the work process more efficient. The code **efficiency** was chosen because the participant described AI as making work easier and faster. The code **task support** was chosen because AI helped with summarizing customer calls and reduced manual logging. This led to the sub-theme, because AI supported employees in focusing more on the customer errand.	AI as an efficiency tool	
P2 (P3,6,10)	"I view it as a good tool, especially for newer employees. There's so much information to process, so to have an AI tool to get information, you can come in and work with it a lot easier."	New employee support	Participants 2 and 4 show that AI made information and work tasks easier to manage. The code **new employee support was** chosen because AI helped employees, especially newer ones, understand information more easily. The code **time- efficiency** was chosen because AI reduced the need to write everything manually after customer calls. This led to the sub-theme, because AI helped employees save time and work more smoothly.	Accessible and practical support	
P4 (P2,3,6,7)	"It helps a lot that it makes the work easier and faster. So when you have a call with a customer, the AI can make everything you have talked about in one take, and you don't have to write the text yourself."	Time-efficient			
P10 (P2,3,6,5)	"Help, definitely. From what I have experienced and my own experiences during these approximately three to four years. Then definitely a help. But one must think about that it was really in the starting stage of AI where these AI tools came in the form of a user interface with a field where you could write and talk with the AI. So a help, yes, definitely."	-Helpful tool -Early-stage AI	Participant 10's quote shows a positive view of AI as a useful support tool. The code **helpful tool** was chosen because the participant described AI as something that supported their work. The code for **early-stage AI** was chosen because the participant also recognized that AI was still developing. This led to the sub-theme because AI was seen as valuable but not yet fully mature.	Positive but developmental support	

4.3 THEME 2: HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY REMAINS CENTRAL DESPITE AI-MEDIATED TASK REDISTRIBUTION

The second main theme, Human responsibility remains central despite AI-mediated task redistribution, was developed from the representative responses presented in Table 6. The participants did not describe AI as producing a complete transformation of customer service

work, nor did they suggest that human responsibility had been removed. Instead, their responses pointed to a more nuanced analytical pattern: AI had redistributed certain work tasks, particularly those connected to documentation, information retrieval, summarizing, and administrative support, while the responsibility for interpretation, accuracy, and final case quality remained with the employee. The theme was therefore created to capture this tension between technological support and continued human accountability.

The first part of the theme, AI-mediated task redistribution, emerged from participants' descriptions of how AI changed the organization of everyday tasks. Participants 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, and 10 contributed to this part of the analysis by describing AI as a system that supported or partially took over specific task elements rather than entire work roles. Their responses led to codes related to documentation support, information retrieval, summarizing, reduced manual writing, and administrative assistance. These codes were not interpreted as evidence of full automation, but as signs that AI had shifted how certain parts of customer service work were carried out. In this sense, AI-mediated task redistribution refers to the way AI reorganizes the practical flow of work without removing the employee from the process.

The second part of the theme, human responsibility, remains central and was developed from the participants' repeated emphasis on human judgment, control, and accountability. Participant 1 was particularly important in shaping this interpretation, as the response showed that AI-generated material still required human review before it could be accepted as accurate or useful. This contributed to codes such as verification responsibility, accuracy control, and employee accountability. Other participants strengthened this analytical direction by describing the need to evaluate whether AI-generated information was relevant, correct, and appropriate for the specific customer case. These responses showed that AI could assist with the work process, but the responsibility for ensuring that the work was properly completed remained with humans.

This distinction was important because the data did not support a theme focused only on efficiency or automation. Although several participants described AI as making tasks faster or more structured, their responses also showed that speed alone was not enough to define the role of AI in customer service work. The employee still had to interpret the customer's situation, assess the meaning of AI-generated outputs, and ensure that the final response or documentation met professional standards. Therefore, the theme was not framed as AI replaces human responsibility, because the participants' accounts clearly showed that

responsibility was not transferred to AI. Instead, AI changed the distribution of certain tasks while leaving the employee accountable for the final outcome.

Table 6: Theme 2

Participant number (Participants with similar ideas)	Participant Quote	Code/s	Coding rationale	Sub-theme	Main theme
P1 (P2,3,8)	"It hasn't affected any responsibilities at all. It's still just the logging that takes a bit longer." "It adds an extra step to the workflow."	-Human validation burden -Workflow extension	Participant 1's quote shows that AI did not change the main responsibility, but it made the logging process longer. The code **human validation burden** was chosen because the employee still had to check the AI-generated text. The code **workflow extension** was chosen because AI added an extra step instead of fully reducing the task. This led to the sub-theme because AI support still required human control.	Added responsibility through verification	Human responsibility remains central despite AI-mediated task redistribution
P2 (P3,7,10)	"Yeah. It could be useful. Let's say the customer could just write in a message, and the AI will fix it, order it. But it would also make it so that we would work with more complex errands more. It would give us more time for the complex errands, which would be good."	-Task reallocation -Complexity shift	Participant 2's quote shows that AI could handle simpler tasks and leave more complex cases to employees. The code **task reallocation** was chosen because some work was shifted toward AI. The code **complexity shift** was chosen because employees could focus more on difficult customer errands. This led to the sub-theme because AI changed the type of work employees focused on.	AI frees capacity for complex errands	
P3 (P2,4,5,7)	"This change may actually have increased motivation at work, because things have become easier and smoother especially during the time we spend handling phone calls. I don't know how AI will affect in-person customer interactions, but there will probably be future developments that make that easier as well. I feel that I can focus much more on the actual errand rather than the logging now that we use AI. Before, I used to keep notes beside me during the call to help with logging afterward, but now the AI handles that automatically. So I can concentrate more on the errand itself, which is very beneficial."	-Administrative offloading - Role refocusing	Participant 3's quote shows that AI helped reduce manual logging and note-taking. The code **administrative offloading** was chosen because AI took over part of the documentation work. The code **role refocusing** was chosen because the employee could focus more on the customer's actual errand. This led to the sub-theme because AI moved attention from administration to customer support.	Reduced logging, stronger focus on core tasks	
P4 (P3,2,5,1)	"Yes, it has affected it, as mentioned, in a positive way in that it has simplified things or made it so that you work faster, and that it, well, that it goes faster and is more efficient."	-Process acceleration -Operational efficiency	Participant 4's quote shows that AI made some work tasks faster and easier. The code **process acceleration** was chosen because AI improved the speed of the work process. The code **operational efficiency** was chosen because AI helped make everyday routines smoother. This led to the sub-theme because AI was experienced as practical support in daily work.	AI streamlines everyday work	
P5 (P1,2,3,6)	"I do not think it has affected that much. We have not come very far, I would say. I would say that we are still at step one. The only thing it really does is summarize and log. Then there is not much other impact it has on my everyday work today at least."	-Surface-level integration -Limited impact	Participant 5's quote shows that AI had only a limited effect on work responsibilities. The code **surface-level integration** was chosen because AI was mainly used for logging and summaries. The code **limited impact** was chosen because the participant did not describe a major role change. This led to the sub-theme because AI was present but did not deeply transform the job.	Early-stage AI with restricted role effect	
P6 (P1,2,3,6,7)	"I do not know if it has affected that much actually. I still have the same areas of responsibility. It is not like it has taken my job in any way. So I do not really think it has changed that much."	-Role continuity -Low displacement perception	Participant 6's quote shows that AI did not replace the employee's professional role. The code **role continuity** was chosen because the main responsibilities remained the same. The code **low displacement perception** was chosen because the participant did not see AI as taking over the job. This led to the sub-theme because AI was viewed as support rather than replacement.	Professional position remains largely unchanged	

P7 (P2,P3,P6,P8)	"Responsibilities in themselves, the only responsibility one actually has, it is to solve the customer's problem. Of course it can be like small things on the side, that you should keep a clean desk, arrive on time to work. But I think specifically responsibilities in themselves. The AI has really only become more efficient so that one can help more customers' problems in that errand."	-Core responsibility retention -Service capacity expansion	Participant 7's quote shows that the employee was still responsible for solving the customer's problem. The code **core responsibility retention** was chosen because human responsibility remained central. The code **capacity expansion** was chosen because AI could help employees manage work more efficiently. This led to the sub-theme because AI supported the work but did not remove human responsibility.	Efficiency support, but does not replace, customer responsibility	
P8 (P1,P2,P3)	"It becomes that one is extra careful with checking what has been summarized, for example. That one does not, as I said then, so that it does not say performed if one has maybe only informed. Because there is such a big difference between doing something and only informing."	-Accountability for AI output -Risk-sensitive verification	Participant 8's quote shows that AI summaries still needed careful checking. The code **accountability for AI output** was chosen because the employee remained responsible for the final information. The code **risk-sensitive verification** was chosen because small mistakes in wording could change the meaning of a case. This led to the sub-theme because human oversight remained necessary.	Human oversight remains essential	
P10 (P2,P3,P5)	"The little I have used the AI in the areas where it is possible then it has still affected me in my professional role in such a way that the meetings become more efficient. I do not need to bring forward a conditions appendix and read through it in order to see where I find the information, but I ask my question in the AI tool and get an answer fairly immediately."	-Knowledge retrieval support -Professional enablement	Participant 10's quote shows that AI helped employees find information faster. The code **knowledge retrieval support** was chosen because AI reduced the need to search manually. The code **professional enablement** was chosen because faster information access helped the employee perform the role better. This led to the sub-theme because AI strengthened the employee's work rather than replacing it.	AI strengthens the professional role through faster information access	

4.4 THEME 3: AI AS A SITUATIONAL SOURCE OF MOTIVATION AND EMOTIONAL SUPPORT

The third main theme, "AI as a situational source of motivation and emotional support," emerged from participants' descriptions of AI's impact on their motivation, engagement, and emotional experiences in the workplace. While Theme 1 focused on views of AI as a support tool for the workplace, Theme 3 explores how the technology influenced employees' emotional reactions to their work. The results show that AI did not produce a consistent motivational reaction. A portion of the participants noted minimal to no shift in their motivation, while others experienced a clear boost in motivation. Meanwhile, a third group largely perceived AI as a helpful tool that facilitated their work without directly influencing their motivation. This diversity is key to the overall theme. AI-facilitated motivation occurred solely under particular circumstances, such as when it lessened stress, provided extra time, improved customer engagement, or boosted employees' feelings of competence and professional accountability.

The initial category in this theme includes participants who did not view AI as having a significant impact on motivation. Participant 1 mentioned that AI felt like an extra responsibility that did not notably enhance motivation. This indicates that incorporating AI into the workflow did not inherently boost motivation. For this participant, the tool did not significantly change the emotional importance of the work. Participant 7 likewise stated that their motivation stayed mostly the same, but they found it helpful not to concentrate on the writing aspect of the job. These findings suggest that although AI might lessen certain efforts, it didn't inherently promote higher engagement or stronger motivation. This category highlights that the motivational effect of AI wasn't consistent across all individuals, for certain employees, AI proved to be beneficial but lacked emotional depth.

The second category includes participants who indicated a notable positive influence of AI on their motivation. Participant 3 mentioned a considerable boost in motivation after AI was introduced, crediting this to the enhanced simplicity of everyday tasks and the opportunity to establish more ambitious personal objectives. This response indicates that AI has the potential to boost motivation by helping employees organize their tasks better and seek opportunities for professional growth. Participant 4 connected AI with higher levels of engagement and satisfaction, especially because it provides extra time for other tasks. Likewise, Participant 10 considered AI advantageous for motivation as it enabled quicker and more efficient task execution. These examples demonstrate that AI served as a motivator when it enhanced feelings of progress, ability, and accomplishment. In these situations, AI not only alleviated workload but also helped create a more positive emotional atmosphere, enabling employees to feel more efficient and skilled.

The third category involves participants who mainly encountered AI as a form of practical assistance, offering motivational advantages that were more indirect. Participant 2 mentioned that AI didn’t necessarily boost motivation but removed elements that had previously caused demotivation. This difference emphasizes that motivation wasn’t always boosted by increased excitement or involvement. In certain cases, AI helped boost motivation by reducing negative feelings like frustration, pressure, or mental exhaustion. Participant 5 explained how AI-generated summaries enhanced their engagement in customer meetings, sharpened their focus on customer interactions, and allowed for improved support. Participant 6 also pointed out that AI enabled a more profound connection with customers and their requirements. These insights indicate that the emotional significance of AI was strongly tied to the relational dimensions of customer service. By minimizing the distraction caused by the need

to handle documentation while interacting, employees were able to be more attentive to customers, leading to work that felt more concentrated and purposeful.

The influence of motivation was indirectly observed in how participants discussed accuracy, accountability, and self-reflection. Participant 8 mentioned that AI encouraged them to deliver precise information since the tool records conversations, highlighting the importance of accuracy. This finding indicates that AI can enhance a stronger sense of professional accountability. In addition to making tasks easier, AI has heightened certain employees' mindfulness regarding the quality of their performance. Participant 9 shared how AI allowed for time to get ready for future customer meetings and to think back on prior interactions. This suggests that AI can enhance a more thoughtful work process, connecting motivation with learning, readiness, and growth. In such instances, the worth of AI goes beyond just its practical applications to include emotional and professional aspects, aiding employees in feeling more engaged, equipped, and aware of their responsibilities.

These three categories together represent the evolution of the main theme. The theme was not exclusively centered around participants who found AI inspiring, as that would provide an incomplete viewpoint. It was also not solely focused on those who saw AI as a useful aid, as that would overlook the emotional and motivational shifts noted by others. The theme developed from the interaction of various participant experiences. Certain employees viewed AI as having limited motivational impact, while others found it to be explicitly motivating, and some saw it as indirectly helpful by lessening strain, improving customer engagement, or providing more chances for reflection. The word "conditional" holds considerable importance: the motivation provided by AI was contingent upon its ability to positively and significantly transform the work experiences of employees.

Table 7: Theme 3

Participant number (Participants with similar ideas)	Participant Quote	Code/s	Coding rationale	Sub-theme	Main theme
P1 (P,2,7)	"There's really no difference. It's just an additional task, but not significant enough to affect motivation."	-Motivation -Naturality -Marginal burden	Participant 1's quote shows that AI did not have a clear effect on motivation. The code **motivation** was chosen because the participant directly discussed motivation. **Naturality** was chosen because AI seemed to be accepted as part of the work, while **marginal burden** was chosen because it was described as "just an additional task." This led to the sub-theme, because AI was noticed but not experienced as important enough to change motivation.	Added task with a minimal motivation effect	AI's motivational value emerges primarily through reduced routines, strain, stronger customer focus, and improved work quality
P2 (P,1,7,9,)	"I don't necessarily say that it motivates me more, but it takes away a thing that could be demotivating when it comes to what's happened before in the errands like that."	-Demotivation -Reduction -Task relief	Participant 2's quote shows that AI did not directly increase motivation, but removed something that could feel demotivating. The code **demotivation** was chosen because the participant referred to a negative part of the work. **Reduction** and **task relief** were chosen because AI reduced this burden. This led to the sub-theme, because AI supported motivation by reducing strain rather than creating motivation directly.	AI removes frustration element of work	
P3 (P,4,9,10)	"My motivation has improved significantly after AI was introduced. As I mentioned, I've started setting higher goals for myself because the daily work has become easier. So personal development and goal-setting have improved."	-Development -Motivation -Goal intensification	Participant 3's quote shows a clear link between AI and increased motivation. The code **development** was chosen because the participant mentioned personal development. **Motivation** was chosen because motivation had improved, and **goal intensification** was chosen because the participant started setting higher goals. This led to the sub-theme because AI made work feel easier and created space for ambition and development.	AI enables growth-oriented motivation	
P4 (P,3,9,10)	"Yes, it has made my engagement increase in a way, and I become more satisfied because I may have time to do more things."	-Enhance engagement -Time enabled -Satisfaction	Participant 4's quote shows that AI increased engagement and satisfaction by creating more time. The code **enhance engagement** was chosen because the participant described increased engagement. **Time enabled** was chosen because AI created time for more tasks, and **satisfaction** because this made the participant more satisfied. This led to the sub-theme, because AI created more space in the workday, which made the participant feel more engaged and satisfied.	Greater time flexibility increases engagement	
P5 (P,3,7,9)	"Right now it is mainly the summary. That it captures all the summary. You can be more present in the customer meeting. You can focus more on what the customer says and be more helpful."	-Customer presence -Relation focus	Participant 5's quote shows that AI helped the employee be more present in customer meetings. The code **customer presence** was chosen because AI made it easier to focus during the meeting. **Relation focus** was chosen because the participant could listen more closely and be more helpful. This led to the sub-theme, because AI shifted attention toward the relational and meaningful part of the role.	AI strengthens customer-centered work	

P6 (P,1,2,6)	"But it is a bit like you say, first and foremost, with the engagement, that one becomes more engaged in the customer and the customer's needs, and that one focuses more on how can I help the customer, what can I offer the customer and make easier for them with things that they maybe do not know that they need help with, those kinds of things"	-Service engagement -Needs orientation	Participant 6's quote shows that AI increased engagement with the customer and their needs. The code **service engagement** was chosen because the participant focused more on helping the customer. **Needs orientation** was chosen because the quote emphasizes identifying what the customer needs. This led to the sub-theme, because AI redirected motivation toward service and customer care.	Motivation shift towards customer support	
P7 (P,1,2,6)	"I cannot write, so that is very nice. But then my motivation in itself, yes, I would say it is the same, but it is just that one does not have to think about that particular part"	-Stable motivation -Conjunctive relief	Participant 7's quote shows that AI did not change motivation itself, but created relief from writing. The code **stable motivation** was chosen because motivation remained the same. **Conjunctive relief** was chosen because the participant valued not having to think about the writing task. This led to the sub-theme, because AI improved one part of the work but did not change the overall motivation.	Task relief without motivation change	
P8 (P,1,2,3,9)	"Yes, it has motivated me to give out correct information to customers, because it will write down regardless of whether one has said the right or the incorrect thing. So that also means that the quality of one's job actually becomes better, because one must be careful with everything."	-Accuracy -Motivation -Quality accountability	Participant 8's quote shows that AI influenced motivation through accuracy and work quality. The code **accuracy** was chosen because the participant became more careful about giving correct information. **Motivation** was chosen because the participant directly described this as motivating, and **quality accountability** because AI made the quality of the interaction more visible. This led to the sub-theme, because AI increased awareness of responsibility and work quality.	AI reinforces careful and correct performance	
P9 (P3.4.10)	"One also has time to prepare a little for the next one, instead of like taking one's time to log and write, so that there is a common thread and so that everything becomes correct. Then I can also kind of reflect a little after the meeting and then look a little at what one did well, if one did something a little less well. So yes, I think that it raises motivation."	-Reflective improvement -Preparation capacity	Participant 9's quote shows that AI created more space for preparation and reflection. The code **reflective improvement** was chosen because the participant could evaluate what went well or less well. **Preparation capacity** was chosen because AI created time to prepare for the next meeting. This led to the sub-theme, because AI supported learning and a more thoughtful way of working.	AI creates space for reflection and improvement	
P10 (P2,3,4,5.6)	"But work motivation connected to using an AI tool, yes, it is positive. Because you get there faster. You can deliver faster. You can be more efficient. Yes. So it is really only positive motivation in that errand. Increased motivation."	-Performance motivation -Efficiency -Drive	Participant 10's quote shows that AI increased motivation through speed and efficiency. The code **performance motivation** was chosen because the participant connected AI to positive work motivation. **Efficiency** was chosen because AI helped the work go faster, and **drive** because the quote shows a stronger sense of progress. This led to the sub-theme, because AI made the work feel more productive and goal-directed.	Speed and efficiency enhance motivation	

4.5 THEME 4: AI-DRIVEN UNCERTAINTY REGARDING JOB SECURITY, DATA PROTECTION, AND HUMAN JUDGMENT

The fourth main theme, “uncertainty about job security, data privacy, and human judgment driven by AI,” arose from participants’ insights on the potential risks and future implications of AI in banking customer service. As shown in Table 8, participants voiced worries regarding job displacement, data security breaches, inaccurate AI results, customer acceptance, and adherence to banking protocols. These worries were viewed as interconnected reflections of a larger uncertainty surrounding the future function of AI within banking operations. This theme was chosen because it captures three key issues highlighted in the data: safeguarding human jobs, ensuring the confidentiality of sensitive customer data, and the dependability of AI without continual human supervision.

The initial category of this theme focuses on uncertainty regarding future employment. Multiple participants expressed the idea that AI might slowly diminish the necessity for human workers. Participant 1 mentioned a widespread belief that AI could ultimately take over, whereas Participant 5 connected this worry to the swift progress of AI and the possible danger of job displacement. Participant 10 reflected on how AI might evolve and whether certain job positions could eventually be substituted. The participants did not present the concept of replacement as a straightforward or complete process. Participant 9 proposed that tasks related to administration might be more likely to be automated, while customer service maintains a personal aspect. These views suggest that employees were worried not just about the potential for direct job replacement, but also about how AI could change the nature of their work by taking over specific tasks and reshaping the roles of customer service workers.

The second category focuses on security and confidentiality. Participants repeatedly highlighted that banking deals with sensitive customer information, which heightens the perceived risks of utilizing AI. Participant 2 pointed out that information security is a major concern due to the extremely sensitive nature of banking data. Participant 4 mentioned that AI can handle names, medical conditions, and addresses, whereas Participant 5 recognized the risk of personal data leakage as a major concern. These instances illustrate that the participants’ worries were influenced by the particular context of banking. AI was assessed not just for its utility or effectiveness, but also for its capacity to safeguard customer information and meet the security standards of the financial services sector.

The third category highlights the continuing importance of human judgment. A number of participants viewed AI as unsafe when it misreads data, delivers inaccurate answers, or does not follow established protocols. Participant 1 noted that AI occasionally misinterpreted customers and changed the intended significance of their comments. Participant 6 pointed out that inaccurate AI replies could lead employees to operate beyond acceptable limits, while Participant 8 pointed out that AI might not fully grasp banking procedures, especially when dealing with sensitive personal information. Participant 6 also raised the concern of whether AI would be appropriate for every customer, implying that trust and customer acceptance contribute significantly to the overall level of concern. The feedback indicates that errors made by AI were seen as important problems. Within the controlled environment of banking, incorrect or unsuitable AI results can lead to practical, ethical, and compliance-related challenges.

These three categories together demonstrate the evolution of the main theme. Worries about job displacement reveal apprehension about the future position of workers. Fears surrounding data breaches emphasize concerns regarding the safeguarding of customers. Issues related to inaccurate results, compliance with regulations, and customer confidence highlight uncertainties about the secure functioning of AI in the absence of human oversight. The main theme illustrates the relationship between these issues. Theme 4 reveals that changes driven by AI were seen as an issue for organizations looking towards the future. Participants expected a deeper incorporation of AI into banking operations, but still considered human oversight crucial because of the sensitive nature of information, regulatory obligations, ethical duties, and the significance of maintaining customer trust.

Table 8: Theme 4

Participant number (Participants with similar ideas)	Participant Quote	Code/s	Coding rationale	Sub-theme	Main theme
P1 (P,2,5,8,10)	"Hard to say, but in general, it seems like most people believe AI will take over sooner or later." "One issue is that it sometimes writes incorrectly. We have something called KMM, customer satisfaction measurement. In several errands, the AI has completely misunderstood what the customer is saying and replaces the customer's words with either words that don't exist or words that mean something entirely different."	- Replacement anticipation - Output misinterpretation	Participant 1's quote shows worry about both future replacement and AI's reliability. The code **replacement anticipation** was chosen because the participant refers to the belief that AI may take over in the future. The code **output misinterpretation** was chosen because the participant described AI misunderstanding customers and changing the meaning of their words. This led to the sub-theme, because AI creates uncertainty about future employment while also raising concerns about whether its output can be trusted.	Future job uncertainty and reliability concern	AI adoption creates future-oriented uncertainty around job security, data protection, and the continued need for human judgment
P2 (P,2,4,10)	"I would say data security is a big thing that probably that's also one thing that would probably make it a bit slower when it comes to banking if you compare it to other customer support, because it's so much sensitive information." "Yeah, so that's the main thing, information security. Also, of course, for the job itself, if the AI gets good enough and people get comfortable enough to use it a lot, you won't really need that many customer support workers."	- Data security anxiety - Workforce reduction	Participant 2's quote shows concern about information security and the future need for employees. The code **data security anxiety** was chosen because the participant emphasized that banking contains sensitive information. The code **workforce reduction** was chosen because the participant suggested that fewer customer support workers may be needed if AI becomes good enough. This led to the sub-theme, because AI raises concerns about both protecting sensitive customer information and reducing the need for human employees.	Security and role redundancy concerns	
P4 (P,2,5,8,10)	"No, it can write names, medical conditions, addresses." "On the negative side, it can lead to us humans no longer being needed since AI can answer and summarize everything. There already exists self-service when you call in, where you can speak to a robot and resolve matters. And that means that in the end, if it continues in this direction, people might lose their jobs because we are not needed. Because, well, AI robots and similar things take over."	- Sensitive data exposure - Human redundancy fear	Participant 4's quote shows concern about sensitive information and the possibility that humans may become less needed. The code **sensitive data exposure** was chosen because the participant mentioned names, medical conditions, and addresses as information that AI could write. The code **human redundancy fear** was chosen because the participant describes AI, robots, and self-service as possible replacements for human employees. This led to the sub-theme, because AI may expose private customer information while also increasing fears that automation could replace human work.	Privacy exposure and automation threat	
P5 (P,2,4,10)	"The risk for me is that AI develops very fast, that you do not have your job left. That is probably the biggest risk for someone working in customer service." "Yes, it is a bit that something might go wrong, that some personal data and sensitive information leaks. That is probably the biggest danger, I would say. This is a profession where it must be very secure. So it must not happen that something like that goes wrong."	- Accelerated displacement risk - Personal data leakage risk	Participant 5's quote shows anxiety about AI developing quickly and creating risks for both employment and data security. The code **accelerated displacement risk** was chosen because the participant describes the fast development of AI as a risk to keeping one's job. The code **personal data leakage risk** was chosen because the participant identifies leakage of sensitive information as a major danger. This led to the sub-theme, because AI is experienced as a future risk to both job security and customer data protection.	Employment anxiety and security risk	

P6 (P1,4,8,9)	"Well it is that I do not think that it suits all customers. One already knows now. We have some small chatbot that one can write with. I have never heard anyone say anything positive about it. So I am a little uncertain actually about how it will be perceived by the customer." "Well, partly that one shares information that one maybe cannot share. But then one also knows that AI does not always have 100% correct answers. So if one asks AI something and then receives an answer that one thinks is correct, then it can go very wrong that one does something that one is not allowed to do or like that. So that is a risk, absolutely."	- Customer acceptance uncertainty - Compliance risk	Participant 6's quote shows uncertainty about whether AI will be accepted by customers and whether it can be used safely. The code **customer acceptance uncertainty** was chosen because the participant questions whether AI suits all customers. The code **compliance risk** was chosen because the participant explained that incorrect AI answers could lead employees to act in ways they are not allowed to. This led to the sub-theme, because AI may weaken customer trust and create risks of wrong or non-compliant actions.	Customer trust and inappropriate action risk	
P8 (p,4,6,9)	"Then we do not follow the bank rules, I mean. And not our way of working either, our routines. We have a way to handle for example people with protected personal data. And these are things that I think AI does not perceive." "One maybe will not have any job left, because it will not be needed as much."	- Procedural misalignment - Partial displacement	Participant 8's quote shows concern that AI may not understand bank routines and protected customer cases. The code **procedural misalignment** was chosen because the participant explained that AI may not follow bank rules or routines, especially around protected personal data. The code **partial displacement** was chosen because the participant also suggested that fewer human employees may be needed. This led to the sub-theme, because AI may fail to follow professional procedures while also creating uncertainty about the future need for employees.	Rule noncompliance and reduced human need	
P9 (P,1,4,6,8)	"I think that it will replace very many things. As said, I think that those who sit with the administrative stuff sit a little loosely. But for customer service it is still very personal." "That can probably be included but I have never experienced it. I do not talk to that many protected personal data customers via the phone. But it can probably happen. That is probably it. And then one always has to be careful to read through every AI summary, even if one thinks that it is a simple one one still has to stand for what it has written."	- Task-based displacement - Ethical unease - Potential confidentiality risk	Participant 9's quote shows concern about selective replacement, confidentiality, and the responsibility to check AI output. The code **task-based displacement** was chosen because the participant suggested that administrative work may be more vulnerable to replacement. The code **ethical unease** was chosen because the quote reflects concern about the broader consequences of AI replacing work. The code **potential confidentiality risk** was chosen because the participant mentioned protected personal data and the need to carefully read through AI summaries. This led to the sub-theme, because AI may replace some tasks while still raising concerns about responsibility, confidentiality, and wider consequences for work.	Selective replacement and societal concern	
P10 (P,1,2,4,5)	"So far positively. One never knows how it will look further ahead. If one will completely be replaced by an AI. Regardless of in what form the AI will be, meaning whether it will be digital or whether there will sit a robot with AI characteristics like. So I do not think there are any limits to it. I think that it can develop very much and replace certain professional roles." "Intrusion, leakage. Yes, exactly. Meaning leakage of information, absolutely but then it feels like then it would need to have access to sensitive tools and databases within the work in order to do that and be able to make its own decisions. That feels a little far ahead. But it is definitely, I definitely think that it can be a risk, yes."	- Open-ended replacement uncertainty - Data-intrusion risk	Participant 10's quote shows long-term uncertainty about AI development and future security risks. The code **open-ended replacement uncertainty** was chosen because the participant explained that no one knows how AI will develop or whether it may replace professional roles. The code **data-intrusion risk** was chosen because the participant mentioned intrusion and information leakage as possible risks. This led to the sub-theme, because AI creates uncertainty about future replacement while also raising concerns about possible security weaknesses.	Long-term uncertainty and future security vulnerability	

5. ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION

5.1 INTRODUCTION

This chapter analyses and discusses how customer service employees in banks perceive AI-driven organizational change and how these perceptions shape their motivation. The previous chapter presented the findings through four main themes developed from the interview material, where participant quotations were connected to codes, sub-themes, meanings, and the research question. This chapter builds on that structure by discussing the themes in relation to the theoretical framework and previous research, rather than treating the findings as separate from the discussion.

The analysis follows the same thematic structure as the findings. Themes 1 and 2 are discussed together because they both concern how AI changes daily work: first as a helpful but imperfect workplace support tool, and then as a form of task redistribution where human responsibility remains central. Theme 3 then focuses more directly on motivation, showing how AI can influence employees through reduced routines, reduced strain, stronger customer focus, and improved work quality. Theme 4 discusses employees' worries, adjustment, and future expectations, especially in relation to job security, data protection, customer trust, and the continued need for human judgment.

The discussion is mainly interpreted through Sheldon's organizational change theory and Self-Determination Theory. Sheldon's theory is useful because it helps explain whether AI is experienced as normal change, where it improves specific routines, or as having paradigmatic change potential when it begins to affect responsibility, control, values, motivation, and the future meaning of customer service work. The concept of fit is also important because the findings show that AI is viewed more positively when it supports the relationship between technology, tasks, and employee responsibility, but more negatively when it creates uncertainty or unclear accountability. Self-Determination Theory is used to understand how AI affects motivation through autonomy, competence, and relatedness. In this way, the chapter discusses not only whether employees accept or resist AI, but also how they interpret AI's role in their work and how this interpretation shapes motivation.

5.2 THEME 1 AND 2: AI AS SUPPORT, AND HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY

The findings from Theme 1 and Theme 2 suggest that customer service employees do not interpret AI-driven change as either fully positive or fully threatening, but as a partial reorganization of work where usefulness and uncertainty exist at the same time. Codes such as “efficiency, task support, time efficient, and helpful tools” show that AI is perceived as valuable when it reduces manual writing, improves access to information, and helps employees focus more on customer-related tasks. However, codes such as “double work, inaccuracy, misinterpretation, and verification burden” show that the same technology also creates new responsibilities when employees must check, correct, and validate AI output. This mixed perception supports Oreg et al.’s (2011) view that employee reactions to change are not one-dimensional, but include cognitive, affective, and behavioral elements, while Sheldon’s (1980) theory gives a deeper explanation by showing that AI affects the fit between technology, tasks, control, and motivation.

From Sheldon’s perspective, the positive codes in Theme 1 suggest that AI is currently experienced mainly as normal change, because it adjusts one part of the work system without fully changing the deeper organizational paradigm. Sheldon (1980) argues that organizations constantly “tinker” with dimensions such as technology, structure, motivation, and control in order to restore fit with a changing environment. This is visible in codes such as “efficiency, task support, new employee support, and time efficient” because AI is not described as replacing the meaning of customer service work, but as improving the practical flow of tasks. Kaya (2019) supports this interpretation by explaining that AI in banking is strongly connected to efficiency, labor productivity, and competitiveness, but his banking-focused argument becomes more complex when placed beside Sheldon, because efficiency alone does not prove that the internal organizational fit is stable.

This is where the negative codes become theoretically important. “Double work, inaccuracy, misinterpretation, and verification burden” show that AI may improve one dimension of the organization while creating tension in another. Sheldon (1980) argues that organizational fit requires alignment between the internal and external factors, meaning technology, structure, control systems, and motivation, but the findings show that the technological dimension has changed faster than the accountability structure. In other words, AI can produce summaries, but employees still remain responsible for the consequences of mistakes. This connects

strongly to Kaya's (2019) warning that banking AI faces special challenges because banking decisions must remain traceable, transparent, and compliant, meaning that human oversight may reduce some of the efficiency gains AI delivers.

Theme 2 strengthens this argument by showing that AI has redistributed tasks rather than removed human responsibility. Codes such as "administrative offloading, task relocation, process acceleration, and knowledge retrieval support" show that AI can take over smaller routine activities, such as logging, summarizing, and finding information. At the same time, codes such as "human validation burden, accountability for AI output, core responsibility retention, and risk-sensitive verification" show that the human employee remains central in ensuring that the customer case is understood correctly. This finding challenges a simple automation argument AI may relocate tasks, but it does not relocate responsibility in the same way.

This means that the change is not yet paradigmatic in the full Sheldon sense, but it contains paradigmatic potential. Sheldon (1980) explains that normal change usually affects one dimension, while paradigmatic change occurs when several organizational dimensions must adapt at once. The codes "surface-level integration, limited impact, role continuity, and low displacement perception" suggest that employees currently see AI as a support tool rather than a complete transformation of their professional role. However, "accountability for AI output, risk-sensitive verification, and human validation burden" shows that AI is already touching deeper questions of control, responsibility, trust, and professional judgment. This is why the findings are stronger than simply saying "employees like AI": they show that AI is accepted as long as it supports the existing human-centered service paradigm, but may become more threatening if it begins to redefine what counts as professional work in banking.

Van den Heuvel et al. (2013) help explain why this boundary matters for adaptation. Their study argues that change information and meaning-making are important because employees adapt better when they can understand what the change means for their role and future behavior. In the findings, employees are already making meaning from AI, codes such as "helpful tool, early stage AI, and professional enablement" show that employees interpret AI as useful but still developing, while "misinterpretation and verification burden" show that they also understand its limitations. This supports van den Heuvel et al.'s argument that adaptation is not only about whether change is introduced, but whether employees can connect the change to their own goals, values, and understanding of work.

Holt et al. (2007) add another layer by showing that readiness for change depends on whether employees believe the change is appropriate, personally beneficial, supported by management, and possible to implement. This connects clearly to the codes “new employee support, time efficient, knowledge retrieval support, and professional enablement,” because these codes show that AI can increase readiness when employees experience it as useful for performing their role. However, the codes “double work, inaccuracy, and workflow extension” show that readiness can weaken when AI is experienced as adding responsibility without removing enough workload. Therefore, Holt et al. (2007) help explain why the same AI system can be perceived differently, employees are more likely to accept it when it strengthens their capability and less likely to accept it when it creates extra checking, uncertainty, or unclear accountability.

5.2.1 MOTIVATIONAL INTERPRETATION OF AI-DRIVEN CHANGE (THEME 1- 2)

Self-Determination Theory gives the strongest motivational explanation for these findings. Gagné and Deci (2005) argue that motivation is not only about whether employees are motivated, but also whether their motivation is autonomous or controlled. In Theme 1 and Theme 2, codes such as “task support, administrative offloading, role refocusing, and professional enablement” suggest that AI may support autonomous motivation because employees can focus more on meaningful customer work and feel more competent in handling tasks. Legault (2017) strengthens this by explaining that autonomy, competence, and relatedness are central psychological needs, meaning that AI supports motivation when it helps employees feel capable, self-directed, and still connected to the human purpose of their work.

At the same time, SDT also explains why AI can weaken motivation if it is experienced as controlling or unreliable. Gagné and Deci (2005) argue that external pressure, surveillance, and reduced autonomy can undermine intrinsic motivation, while Legault (2017) explains that people may become demotivated when the social environment frustrates autonomy, competence, or relatedness. This connects directly to “human validation burden, workflow extension, inaccuracy, and misinterpretation” because these codes show that AI can make employees feel responsible for a system they do not fully control. Croitoru et al. (2025) support this tension by arguing that AI can improve motivation and performance, but this

effect depends on employee acceptance, transparency, user-friendliness, ethical implementation, and whether AI is experienced as empowerment rather than control.

This creates an important answer to the research question. Customer service employees seem to perceive AI-driven organizational change as useful when it strengthens their ability to perform customer service, but problematic when it increases responsibility without enough reliability. Their motivation is therefore shaped through the meaning they attach to AI: when AI is interpreted through codes such as "efficiency, task support, administrative offloading, and professional enablement" it can support competence and autonomous motivation. When AI is interpreted through "double work, verification burden, misinterpretation, and risk-sensitive verification", it may create controlled motivation because employees use AI not because they fully trust it, but because the organization expects them to work with it. This fits both SDT and organizational change theory, because motivation is shaped not only by the tool itself, but by how the tool fits into work roles, accountability, and employee meaning-making.

Overall, the combined discussion of Theme 1 and Theme 2 shows that AI-driven change in banking is best understood as "supportive but incomplete organizational change". Sheldon (1980) helps explain why AI currently appears as a normal change because it improves specific tasks without fully replacing the human-centered customer service paradigm. Oreg et al. (2011), Holt et al. (2007), and Van den Heuvel et al. (2013) make the analysis deeper by showing that employee reactions depend on perceived benefits and risks, readiness, information, and meaning-making. SDT then explains the motivational consequence: AI supports motivation when it strengthens autonomy and competence, but weakens motivation when it creates pressure, uncertainty, or a loss of control. Therefore, the findings suggest that employees are not resisting AI itself, they are evaluating whether AI improves the quality of their work while still preserving human responsibility, professional judgment, and meaningful customer service.

5.3 THEME 3: AI MOTIVATION THROUGH AUTONOMY, COMPETENCE, AND RELATEDNESS

The findings from Theme 3 suggest that AI-driven change does not influence employee motivation in one simple or fixed direction. Instead, the main theme, AI's motivational value, emerges primarily through reduced routines, strain, stronger customer focus, and improved work quality, showing that motivation depends on how AI changes the quality, meaning, and

experience of daily work. Codes such as “Development,” “Motivation,” “Goal intensification,” “Enhance engagement,” “Time enabled,” “Satisfaction,” “Reflective improvement,” “Preparation capacity,” “Performance motivation,” “Efficiency,” and “Drive” indicate that AI can support motivation when it helps employees feel more capable, efficient, and able to improve their work. At the same time, codes such as “Motivation,” “Naturality,” “Marginal burden,” “Stable motivation,” and “Cognitive relief” show that AI does not automatically create stronger motivation simply because it is introduced. This connects directly to Self-Determination Theory, where Gagné and Deci (2005) argue that motivation should be understood through its quality, not only its amount. It also connects to Blagoev et al. (2022), who show that AI and robotization can influence bank employees’ motivation by changing job content, task distribution, and expectations.

The most important contribution of SDT to Theme 3 is that it explains why AI becomes motivating in some situations but not in others. SDT argues that motivation is shaped by the satisfaction of three psychological needs: autonomy, competence, and relatedness (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017). In this theme, the codes “Time enabled,” “Reduction,” “Task relief,” “Enhance engagement,” and “Satisfaction” suggest that AI may support autonomy when it reduces routine pressure and gives employees more control over how they use their time. This means that AI is not motivational only because it makes work faster. Rather, it becomes motivational when employees experience it as giving them more room to manage the workday and focus on more valuable tasks. Croitoru et al. (2025) support this interpretation by arguing that AI can improve motivation and performance when employees experience it as useful, transparent, and supportive rather than controlling. This also connects to the motivation continuum in SDT, because employees are more likely to move toward autonomous motivation when they understand the value of the change and experience it as supportive rather than forced (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017).

The codes connected to competence are also central to understanding the motivational effect of AI. “Development,” “Goal intensification,” “Reflective improvement,” “Preparation capacity,” “Performance motivation,” “Efficiency,” “Drive,” “Accuracy,” and “Quality accountability” show that AI can strengthen motivation when employees feel more prepared, more accurate, and more capable of improving their performance. Legault (2017) explains competence as the need to feel effective, and this helps clarify why AI can become motivating when it supports better work quality. Blagoev et al. (2022) also show that AI and robotization can affect bank employees’ motivation by changing job content, task

distribution, and role expectations. This is further supported by Soulami et al. (2024), who found that workplace AI adoption can influence employee outcomes such as engagement, satisfaction, productivity, and well-being, while also creating challenges if the technology is experienced as stressful or insecure. Therefore, the motivation found in Theme 3 is not mainly about AI as a technology, but about whether AI helps employees experience progress, capability, and professional development in their work.

Theme 3 also shows that motivation is connected to relatedness, especially through the customer-focused codes. “Customer presence,” “Relation focus,” “Service engagement,” and “Needs orientation” indicate that AI can support motivation when it allows employees to focus more on customer interaction instead of administrative tasks. This is important because customer service work in banking is not only about completing tasks efficiently, but also about maintaining trust, communication, and support. Legault (2017) describes relatedness as the need to feel meaningfully connected to others, and these codes suggest that AI may support relatedness when it protects the human and relational purpose of the role. This also fits Prentice and Nguyen (2020) and Prentice et al. (2020), who show that human service remains important even when AI is introduced into service processes. Therefore, AI may support motivation when it strengthens the employee’s ability to provide meaningful customer service rather than only increasing technical efficiency.

5.3.1 CONTROLLED MOTIVATION AND ACCOUNTABILITY PRESSURE

However, the theme also shows that AI can have a limited or controlled motivational effect. Codes such as “Motivation,” “Naturality,” “Marginal burden,” “Stable motivation,” and “Cognitive relief” suggest that AI may make work easier without necessarily changing the employee’s deeper motivation. In SDT, this can be understood through the motivation continuum. AI may remain at a more controlled or neutral level when employees use it mainly because it is part of the work system, rather than because they personally experience it as meaningful or valuable (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017). In Sheldon’s (1980) terms, this reflects normal change because AI adjusts work routines without necessarily changing the deeper meaning of the employee’s role. This is important because it shows that usefulness and motivation are not the same thing. AI can be useful without automatically creating stronger autonomous motivation, especially if employees experience it as a neutral tool or as part of a routine workflow adjustment.

The code “Quality accountability” creates another important tension in the discussion. Together with “Accuracy” and “Motivation,” it suggests that AI may encourage employees to be more careful because their work becomes more visible, traceable, or easier to evaluate. This can improve performance and work quality, but it may also create pressure. Gagné and Deci (2005) explain that controlled motivation occurs when employees act because of external expectations, accountability, or pressure rather than personal value. Croitoru et al. (2025) also emphasize that AI’s motivational effects depend on whether employees experience it as empowerment or control. This means that AI may improve performance while still creating motivational tension if employees feel accountable for outcomes shaped by a system they do not fully control. In this sense, AI can support competence while also increasing pressure if accountability becomes too closely tied to AI-generated output.

5.3.2 ORGANIZATIONAL FIT AND MOTIVATIONAL TENSION

Theme 3 can also be interpreted through Sheldon’s concept of organizational fit. When AI reduces strain, supports development, improves efficiency, and strengthens customer-focused work, it improves the fit between technology, tasks, and employee motivation. In this sense, AI functions as a positive form of normal change, because it improves existing routines without replacing the human-centered meaning of customer service (Sheldon, 1980). However, when AI is experienced through “Marginal burden,” “Stable motivation,” “Cognitive relief,” or “Quality accountability,” the fit becomes weaker because the technology may change how work is carried out without necessarily improving employees’ sense of motivation. This shows that AI-driven change must fit not only the technical workflow, but also employees’ motivational needs. Research on AI in banking also supports this point, since AI can improve efficiency and service processes, but employees’ perceptions, knowledge, confidence, risks, and support remain important for how AI is experienced in practice (Fares et al., 2023; Kalyani & Gupta, 2023; Yuniawan et al., 2025).

Overall, Theme 3 answers the research question by showing that employees’ motivation is shaped by how they interpret AI’s effect on their work experience. AI can strengthen motivation when it supports autonomy by reducing routine pressure, competence by improving preparation and performance, and relatedness by creating more space for customer-focused work. However, AI’s motivational value is weaker when it is experienced as neutral, as an added burden, or as a new form of accountability. Therefore, the findings suggest that AI does not motivate employees by itself. Instead, motivation depends on

whether AI is experienced as meaningful support that improves the quality of work and preserves the human purpose of customer service.

5.4 THEME 4: THE PERCEIVED IMPACT OF AI-DRIVEN CHANGE ON EMPLOYEES' WORRIES, ADJUSTMENT, AND FUTURE ANTICIPATION

The findings from Theme 4 suggest that AI-driven change creates uncertainty around job security, data protection, adjustment, and the continued need for human judgment. Codes such as "Replacement anticipation," "Workforce reduction," "Human redundancy fear," "Accelerated displacement risk," "Task-based displacement," and "Open-ended replacement uncertainty" show that employees connect AI to possible changes in future employment. At the same time, codes such as "Output misinterpretation," "Data security anxiety," "Sensitive-data exposure," "Personal-data leakage risk," "Compliance risk," "Procedural misalignment," "Potential confidentiality risk," and "Data-intrusion risk" show that the uncertainty is not only about job loss, but also about reliability, privacy, compliance, customer trust, and the risks of using AI in a sensitive banking environment. This supports Oreg et al. (2011), whose central contribution is the classification of employee reactions to organizational change into affective, cognitive, and behavioural dimensions.

Oreg et al.'s (2011) framework is useful because Theme 4 does not show simple resistance to AI. Instead, the codes show several types of employee reactions at the same time. The affective dimension is visible in codes such as "Human redundancy fear," "Data security anxiety," "Accelerated displacement risk," "Personal-data leakage risk," "Open-ended replacement uncertainty," and "Data-intrusion risk," because these codes express worry, insecurity, and concern about the future. The cognitive dimension is visible in codes such as "Output misinterpretation," "Procedural misalignment," "Compliance risk," "Partial displacement," and "Potential confidentiality risk," because employees are evaluating whether AI can actually understand banking rules, handle sensitive information, and produce reliable output. The behavioural dimension appears more indirectly through cautious adjustment. The findings do not suggest that employees reject AI completely; rather, they evaluate whether AI can be trusted and how it may affect their role, responsibility, and future position.

5.4.1 READINESS, ADAPTATION, AND EMPLOYEE SUPPORT

Theme 4 also connects strongly to Holt et al.'s (2007) readiness for change framework. The first important dimension is change-specific efficacy, which concerns whether employees believe they are capable of handling the change. Codes such as "Procedural misalignment," "Output misinterpretation," "Compliance risk," and "Potential confidentiality risk" suggest that change-specific efficacy may weaken when employees feel responsible for risks created by AI systems they do not fully control. The second dimension is appropriateness, meaning whether employees believe the change is suitable for the organization. This is visible in concerns around "Customer acceptance uncertainty," "Sensitive-data exposure," "Data security anxiety," and "Data-intrusion risk," because banking is a context where AI must be judged not only by efficiency, but also by security, responsibility, and customer trust. This connects to Kaya (2019), who explains that AI in banking faces challenges related to regulation, transparency, data privacy, and cybersecurity.

The third dimension in Holt et al.'s (2007) framework is management support, which becomes important because employees need guidance about how AI should be used, what its limits are, and where responsibility lies. This connects to codes such as "Compliance risk," "Procedural misalignment," and "Partial displacement," because these codes show that uncertainty can grow when employees are unsure whether AI can follow banking procedures or when human oversight remains necessary. The fourth dimension is personal valence, meaning whether employees believe the change benefits them personally. Codes such as "Workforce reduction," "Human redundancy fear," "Accelerated displacement risk," "Task-based displacement," and "Open-ended replacement uncertainty" suggest that personal valence may weaken when AI is connected to role insecurity or possible replacement. Molla (2024) supports this concern by showing that AI-driven job displacement fears are especially relevant for bank employees whose work includes routine or clerical tasks, while Yuniawan et al. (2025) show that perceived risks, benefits, knowledge, self-confidence, and support influence how financial service employees respond to AI adoption.

Van den Heuvel et al. (2013) add another important explanation through the concepts of adaptation, meaning-making, change information, and support. The codes in Theme 4 show that employees are trying to make sense of what AI means for their future roles. "Replacement anticipation," "Task-based displacement," and "Open-ended replacement uncertainty" show uncertainty about employment, while "Data security anxiety," "Personal-data leakage risk," "Sensitive-data exposure," and "Data-intrusion risk" show

uncertainty about whether AI can safely operate in banking. According to van den Heuvel et al. (2013), employees adapt better when they receive information that helps them understand the change and connect it to their own role and future behaviour. Therefore, these findings suggest that AI-driven change requires not only technical implementation, but also communication and support that help employees understand why AI is used, what it can and cannot do, and why human judgment remains necessary.

5.4.2 ORGANIZATIONAL FIT, HUMAN JUDGMENT, AND MOTIVATION

Sheldon's (1980) theory gives a broader organizational explanation of these worries. A central concept in Sheldon's theory is organizational fit, meaning the relationship between technology, structure, control, values, and motivation. In Theme 4, the codes show that AI may disturb this fit when the technological dimension changes faster than responsibility, trust, role security, or employee understanding. If AI only improves speed, information access, or routine work, it can be understood as normal change. However, codes such as "Replacement anticipation," "Human redundancy fear," "Compliance risk," "Procedural misalignment," "Data-intrusion risk," and "Partial displacement" show that AI has paradigmatic change potential because it touches several organizational dimensions at once. It affects not only tasks, but also accountability, customer trust, data protection, employee value, control, and motivation.

This is why human judgment remains central in Theme 4. Codes such as "Customer acceptance uncertainty," "Compliance risk," "Procedural misalignment," "Partial displacement," "Ethical unease," and "Potential confidentiality risk" show that employees question whether AI can fully understand customer needs, banking routines, confidentiality, and responsible decision-making. Jarrahi (2018) supports this interpretation by arguing that human-AI collaboration works best when AI supports information processing while humans remain responsible for judgment, uncertainty, and context. This means that the issue is not only whether AI can replace tasks, but whether it can replace the professional judgment required in banking customer service. In this sense, AI may be useful as support, but it becomes more problematic when it appears to challenge responsibility, compliance, and the human role in customer trust.

Theme 4 also has a direct motivational meaning through Self-Determination Theory. Codes such as "Workforce reduction," "Human redundancy fear," "Accelerated displacement risk," and "Open-ended replacement uncertainty" may weaken autonomy because employees may

feel less control over their future. Codes such as “Output misinterpretation,” “Procedural misalignment,” “Compliance risk,” and “Potential confidentiality risk” may weaken competence because employees must handle risks created by a system they do not fully control. Concerns about “Customer acceptance uncertainty,” “Ethical unease,” and “Potential confidentiality risk” may also affect relatedness because customer service depends on trust and responsible human interaction. This connects to the motivation continuum in SDT, because employees may move toward more controlled motivation if they use AI mainly because it is required, while feeling uncertain about its effect on their role and future (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017). Soulami et al. (2024) also support this broader tension by showing that workplace AI can create benefits for engagement and productivity, while also creating stress, insecurity, and well-being challenges.

Overall, Theme 4 shows that AI is accepted cautiously because employees connect it to job security, data protection, compliance, customer trust, and the continued need for human judgment. This theme answers the research question by showing that motivation is shaped not only by whether AI makes work easier, but also by whether employees feel secure, informed, supported, and professionally valuable during AI-driven organizational change. In this sense, Theme 4 extends Theme 3: motivation is not only affected by reduced routines or better work quality, but also by whether AI-driven change is understood as appropriate, supported, meaningful, and compatible with the human role in banking.

5.5 OVERALL INTERPRETATION OF THE FOUR THEMES IN RELATION TO THE RESEARCH QUESTION

Taken together, the four themes show that customer service employees perceive AI-driven organizational change as both supportive and uncertain. In relation to the research question, employees do not interpret AI as simply positive or negative. Their perceptions are shaped by how AI affects daily work, responsibility, motivation, and future expectations. Themes 1 and 2 show that AI is useful when it improves efficiency, reduces manual work, supports information access, and allows employees to focus more on customer-related tasks. However, they also show that AI remains incomplete because employees still need to check, correct, and validate AI output. This means that AI may redistribute tasks, but it does not remove human responsibility. Sheldon’s (1980) concept of fit is useful here because AI is perceived more positively when technology, tasks, and employee responsibility work together, but more negatively when AI creates extra verification or unclear accountability.

Theme 3 shows more directly how these perceptions shape motivation. AI becomes motivating when it reduces routines, removes frustrating parts of work, supports customer presence, improves work quality, and creates space for reflection and development. This connects to Self-Determination Theory, since AI can support motivation when it strengthens employees' sense of competence, autonomy, and relatedness (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Legault, 2017). However, Theme 3 also shows that AI does not automatically increase motivation. For some participants, AI is experienced as a neutral tool or an added task with limited motivational effect. This suggests that motivation is shaped less by AI itself and more by whether AI improves the quality and meaning of employees' work.

Theme 4 adds that AI-driven change also creates future-oriented concerns around job security, data protection, customer trust, compliance, and the continued need for human judgment. These concerns indicate that AI can move beyond normal change and gain paradigmatic change potential when it affects several organizational dimensions at the same time, such as tasks, control, responsibility, values, and motivation (Sheldon, 1980). Oreg et al. (2011) support this interpretation because employee reactions to change can include cognitive, affective, and behavioral elements. Holt et al. (2007) and van den Heuvel et al. (2013) also show why support, readiness, information, and meaning-making are important when employees are expected to adapt to organizational change.

Overall, the four themes indicate that AI-driven organizational change in banking is best understood as a conditional form of support. Employees are not necessarily resisting AI, but evaluating whether it improves or complicates their work. AI can strengthen motivation when it supports competence, reduces strain, and protects meaningful customer service. At the same time, motivation may weaken when AI creates uncertainty, accountability pressure, data-security concerns, or fear that the human role can become less valuable. Therefore, the findings answer the research question by showing that customer service employees' motivation is shaped by how they interpret AI's fit with their work role, responsibility, and future place in the organization.

6. CONCLUSION

This conclusion does not aim to repeat what has already been presented in the previous chapters, but to clarify what this study contributes and what its findings indicate. The purpose of this study was to evaluate how customer service employees in banks view AI-driven organizational change and how it affects their motivation. The study shows that employees do

not consider AI as either entirely positive or entirely negative based on the interviews and thematic analysis. Instead, their views differ depending on how AI affects their daily responsibilities, motivation, accountability, and expectations for the future. This implies that AI-driven change in banking should be viewed as an organizational and human transformation process in addition to a technical one.

The results show that AI is frequently seen as a useful workplace support tool when it lowers repetitive tasks, boosts productivity, simplifies information access, and frees up employees to concentrate more on customer-related duties. In this way, AI can be viewed as a type of normal change, where technology enhances current work practices without completely altering the nature of an employee's job. However, employees do not view AI as entirely trustworthy or complete. Even when AI eliminates some tasks, workers may still need to examine, assess, and correct AI-generated output, which can lead to new responsibilities. AI may thereby redistribute work, but it does not replace the need for human accountability, professional judgment, or customer understanding.

The study also shows that AI influences motivation in different ways. AI may have a positive motivational impact on some employees because it lowers stress, eliminates time-consuming administrative tasks, frees up time for customer contact, and encourages higher-quality work. These results imply that AI can boost motivation when workers feel more competent, in control of their work, and connected to the human goal of customer service. This is also supported by Soulami et al. (2024), who show that AI adoption in the workplace can create benefits such as higher autonomy, satisfaction, engagement, and innovation, while also creating challenges connected to stress, insecurity, and employee well-being. However, some employees see AI as neutral or as an additional responsibility, especially if it leads to extra accountability or checking. This suggests that employees' perceptions of AI's role in their work have a greater influence on motivation than AI itself.

The results further illustrate how worries about the future are raised by AI-driven transformation. Participants linked AI to data security, job security, customer trust, compliance, and the continued need for human judgment. These worries show that AI has the potential to become more than a normal change. AI has the capacity to bring about paradigmatic change when it starts to impact accountability, control, role security, values, and motivation all at once. This implies that employees may perceive AI as a component of a more profound change in banking work, even if it is now primarily utilized as a support tool.

The study indicates that a customer service employee's motivation is influenced by how effectively AI fits with their job function, responsibilities, and professional values. AI may boost motivation when it improves productivity, reduces unnecessary stress, and helps workers deliver meaningful customer service. On the other hand, if AI creates doubt about the future worth of human work, uncertainty, unclear responsibility, or fear of replacement, motivation could decline. As a result, how well AI is applied in banking depends not only on the technology's efficiency, but also on whether employees experience AI as supportive, understandable, and aligned with their professional role. The main contribution of this study is therefore that it shows how customer service employees' motivation is shaped by the meaning they give to AI-driven change: AI can strengthen motivation when it supports competence, reduces strain, and protects meaningful customer service, but it can weaken motivation when it creates uncertainty, unclear responsibility, or fear that human work is becoming less valuable.

7. FUTURE RESEARCH

This study has demonstrated the ways in which customer service employees at banks view AI-driven organizational changes and how these views can influence their motivation. However, there is potential for further exploration of this subject in future studies. One potential avenue for research is to explore how employees' perceptions of AI evolve over time. Given that the results indicate AI is presently seen as both beneficial and flawed, future research could investigate whether employees develop greater confidence, motivation, or trust in AI as the technology becomes increasingly dependable and further integrated into routine banking tasks.

Future studies could also involve a more diverse and larger pool of participants. This study concentrated on customer service staff, and the majority of the participants were quite young. This is important because AI is not experienced in the same way by all employees. Xiang et al. (2022) show that younger and older adults differ in how they trust and respond to AI tools. Their study found that younger adults trusted AI more when the AI explanation was connected to behavioural features, while older adults reported trust in AI but were less willing to follow the AI's judgment when it differed from their own. Involving older employees, managerial staff, back-office personnel, and workers from various banking institutions could provide a more comprehensive insight into how AI is viewed across different job roles, age ranges, and levels of experience.

An important area for future research is the relationship between AI, job security, and the well-being of employees. The results indicate that AI can enhance motivation by minimizing repetitive tasks, enabling employees to concentrate more on customer interactions. However, AI can also generate anxiety regarding future job security, data privacy, and the ongoing necessity for human decision-making. Future research could investigate how these issues influence stress levels, engagement, job satisfaction, and employees' readiness to adapt to changes driven by AI.

Ultimately, future studies might explore the viewpoint of customers. Given that this study emphasizes employees, it does not capture how customers perceive AI-enhanced banking services. Investigating customers' trust in AI, their preference for human interaction, and their reactions to a blend of AI and employee services could yield a more comprehensive insight into the changes driven by AI in the banking sector.

7.1 MANAGERIAL IMPLICATIONS/RECOMMENDATIONS

The research indicates that banks ought to consider the implementation of AI as a process of organizational change, rather than merely a technical enhancement. AI influences the tasks, responsibilities, motivation, and job security of employees. Workers exhibited a more favorable attitude towards AI when it minimized repetitive tasks, enhanced efficiency, aided customer interactions, and made them feel more capable in their positions. Therefore, it is essential for managers to communicate clearly that the intention of AI is to assist employees, not to replace them.

Banks should also offer ongoing training and hands-on guidance. As participants noted that AI is beneficial yet still has flaws, it's essential for employees to grasp both the capabilities and limitations of AI. Therefore, the training should emphasize not just how to operate AI tools, but also how to assess AI-generated data, recognize potential inaccuracies, safeguard sensitive customer information, and understand when human judgment is required.

It is essential to define accountability as well. The findings indicate that while AI may take on certain tasks, workers are still tasked with reviewing and confirming the output generated by AI. If this accountability is ambiguous, AI could lead to stress rather than encouragement. Consequently, banks should establish clear procedures for the appropriate use of AI, determine when human oversight is necessary, and outline how employees should respond to erroneous or insufficient AI-generated content.

Ultimately, it’s important to involve employees in the implementation process. Customer service staff interact frequently with both customers and AI-driven systems, so their insights can help pinpoint practical issues and enhance the application of AI. By framing AI as an assistive tool rather than a substitute, banks can alleviate uncertainty, boost motivation, and maintain the essential human judgment that is crucial in banking customer service.

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Appendix

Appendix 1: Interview Guideline

Guideline for Semi structured interview questions (Approximate time: 20–40 minutes)

Interview opening

Hello and good day. I am Mayada, Adriana and Aymen, and we are carrying out this interview for our bachelor's thesis at Mälardalen University.

The aim of this research is to examine how employees in customer service within the banking industry view AI-driven changes within organizations and how these views affect their motivation in the workplace.

Your involvement is entirely optional. All answers will be handled with confidentiality, and no personal information will be included in the final thesis. You are free to skip any questions you wish, and you can exit out of the interview whenever you like.

This interview will be semi-structured and will center on your experiences and perspectives about the implementation of artificial intelligence in your work environment, its impact on your role, and its potential effect on your motivation and future expectations.

If you agree, I would like to record our conversation to ensure I accurately document your answers. The recording will solely be utilized for research purposes and will be kept confidential.

Before we start, would you mind sharing:

Your name or initials

Your Age

Your present position or job title

How long have you worked in the banking sector

How long have you worked in customer service

Whether you utilize AI-driven or digital tools in your everyday tasks.

Theme	Focus	Questions	Extra questions	Approximated time
Theme 1: Employees' views and comprehension of AI in the workplace.	How employees perceive and comprehend AI.	1. What is your perspective on the application of AI in your job and as a customer service employee? 2. How did you respond when AI-based tools or systems were implemented in your workplace? 3. How do you currently view AI in connection to your role at the bank?	1. Do you see that AI has had a positive, negative, or a combination of both impact on your work? 2. Do you perceive AI as assistance, a challenge, an opportunity, or a threat in your work?	10-16 minutes
Theme 2: The perceived impact of AI on job responsibilities and professional positions.	How AI transforms their work environments.	1. How has AI impacted your everyday work assignments? 2. In what ways has AI impacted your job and responsibilities as a customer service employee? 3. In what ways has AI impacted your communication with clients and colleagues?	1. Has AI made your daily tasks faster or easier, and which tasks have been impacted the most? 2. Have there been any changes in your role since the introduction of AI? If so, which are they?	10-14 minutes
Theme 3: The perceived impact of AI-driven changes on employee motivation.	How AI has affected employees' motivation at work.	1. In what ways, if any, have changes related to AI impacted your work motivation? 2. In what ways has AI influenced your level of job satisfaction and your involvement in your work? 3. In what ways has AI affected your perception of your skills, worth, or significance in your job?	1. Which elements of AI have impacted your motivation the most? 2. Has your job become more essential and important or less essential and important? 3. Has the use of AI boosted or diminished your courage in the workplace?	10-15 minutes

Theme 4: Employee worries, adjustments, and future anticipations related to AI	How workers manage AI today and in the future.	1. What worries, if any, do you have regarding the growing implementation of AI in customer service within the banking sector? 2. In what ways have you adjusted to the changes brought by AI in your work environment? 3. What impact do you believe AI will have on your position and the future of customer service jobs in the banking sector?	1. Do you perceive any dangers linked to the use of AI in your work? 2. Do you believe AI will primarily assist employees or take over certain aspects of their jobs?	10-15 minutes

Appendix 2: Interview summary

Participant ID	Gender	Age	Occupation	Interview Duration	Key Focus Areas
Participant 1	Female	Skip	Customer advisor.	18:59	Additional Workload; Impact on Efficiency; Quality of AI outputs; Job satisfaction and Motivation; Future of Employment; Employee Skill Value; Control and Personal Expression; Challenges in Customer Communication; AI as a Tool; Long-Term Perspectives
Participant 2	Male	32	Team leader for sales and services	38:13	Easier Tasks vs. Complex Tasks; AI as an Assistant; Data Security Concerns; Training and Familiarization; Impact on New Employees; Motivation and Job Satisfaction; Feedback and Improvement; Long-Term Job Impact; Efficiency in Documentation; Balancing Workloads
Participant 3	Female	31	Customer advisor.	35:37	Efficiency in Work Processes; Adaptation to AI tools; Impact on Job Roles; AI as a Tool for Summary; Training and Onboarding; Quality of Customer Interactions; Communication Challenges; Future Role of AI; Balancing Human Touch and Automation; Privacy and Security Concerns
Participant 4	Female	22	Customer advisor	34:29	Efficiency and Speed; Reliability and Trust; Personal Data Protection; Impact on Employment; Training and Adaptation; Customer Interaction Dynamics; Balancing Technology and Human Touch; Internal Collaboration; Adaptation of Communication Styles; Long-Term Viability of Roles
Participant 5	Male	20	Customer advisor.	28:56	Efficiency Improvement; Data Logging; User Experience and Accessibility; Potential for Future Impact; Communication Enhancement; Quality Control; Job Security Concerns; Personal Engagement; Future Development; Service Availability

Participant 6	Female	24	Customer advisor.	34:41	Implementation Speed; Role of AI in Customer Service; Impact on Job Responsibilities; Improvement of Communication; Customer Interaction Experience; Concerns bout Confidentiality; Need for training and Education; Mixed feedback on Chatbots; Future of Customer Service Roles; Adaptation to AI Changes
Participant 7	Male	25	Customer advisor.	35:08	Task Automation; Standardization of Information; Enhanced Communication; Feedback Mechanisms; Human-AI Collaboration; Integration with CRM Systems; Reduction of Workload Stress; Future Potential; Privacy and Security Concerns; Adaptation to Technology
Participant 8	Female	27	Customer advisor.	45:51	Training and Support; Human Oversight; Quality of Interactions; Feedback Integrations; AI's Role in Complex Situations; Emotional Intelligence; Workflow Integration; Collaboration Between Teams; Customer Experience Measurement; Future of Banking
Participant 9	Male	20	Customer advisor.	41:04	Efficiency and Workflow Improvement; Human-AI Interaction; Data Privacy and Security; Training and Familiarization; Future of Employment; Customer Experience; Adaptation to Change; Implementation Caution
Participant 10	Male	45	Private advisor	39:02	Background and experience; AI Utilization; Advantages and Disadvantages of AI; Impact on Job Role; Customer Relations; Future Implications; Security and Reliability Concerns; Overall Perception of AI

Appendix 3: Thematic Analysis

Participant	Quotes	Code	Sub-theme	Theme
Participant 1	No, I mean, if anything, it's actually added more work.	Double Work	Verification burden	AI as a helpful but imperfect workplace support tool
Participant 1	Because now, first of all, the customer meeting has to be recorded. Then afterward, when you're logging it, you have to read through what the AI has written, and there are often inaccuracies, maybe reference errors or similar, so you have to edit the text to make it correct. And then you still have to log it yourself, so it ends up being double work.	Inaccuracies		
Participant 8	I mean, it is both good and bad. In one way, I think that it becomes clear what we have done, like what has been said during the conversation. The AI makes it very, very clear and you get much more text than what you can write down yourself. So from that aspect I think that it is very good. I can follow up on what the customer talked about with my colleague, what the matter concerned, what they discussed during the conversation and what the outcome was. However, I think that certain things can be missed in the AI's summary. Sometimes it can say that you maybe performed something when you only gave information, so those kinds of things I think the AI does not really understand or comprehend. So it can also make it more confusing.	Clarity	Clear but imperfect summaries	
		Misinterpretation		
Participant 3	I see AI as a valuable tool because it makes work more efficient. For example, it summarizes customer calls, which allows us to focus on the actual errand rather than the logging. The AI handles that now when we assist customers over the phone.	Efficiency	AI as an efficiency tool	
		Task support		
Participant 2	I view it as a good tool, especially for newer employees. There's so much information to process, so to have an AI tool to get information, you can come in and work with it a lot easier.	New employee support	Accessible and practical support	

Participant 4	It helps a lot that it makes the work easier and faster. So when you have a call with a customer, the AI can make everything you have talked about in one take, and you don't have to write the text yourself.	Time-efficient		
Participant 10	Help, definitely. From what I have experienced and my own experiences during these approximately three to four years. Then definitely a help. But one must think about that it was really in the starting stage of AI where these AI tools came in the form of a user interface with a field where you could write and talk with the AI. So a help, yes, definitely.	Helpful tool Early-stage AI	Positive but developmental support	
Participant 1	It hasn't affected any responsibilities at all. It's still just the logging that takes a bit longer.	Human validation burden Workflow extension	Added responsibility through verification	Human responsibility remains central despite AI-mediated task redistribution
Participant 1	It adds an extra step to the workflow.	Workflow extension		
Participant 2	Yeah. It could be useful. Let's say the customer could just write in a message, and the AI will fix it, order it. But it would also make it so that we would work with more complex errands more. It would give us more time for the complex errands, which would be good.	Task reallocation Complexity shift	AI frees capacity for complex errands	
Participant 3	This change may actually have increased motivation at work, because things have become easier and smoother especially during the time we spend handling phone calls. I don't know how AI will affect in-person customer interactions, but there will probably be future developments that make that easier as well. I feel that I can focus much more on the actual errand rather than the logging now that we use AI. Before, I used to keep notes beside me during the call to help with logging afterward, but now the AI handles that automatically. So I can concentrate more on the errand itself, which is very beneficial.	Administrative offloading Role refocusing	Reduced logging, stronger focus on core tasks	

Participant 4	Yes, it has affected it, as mentioned, in a positive way in that it has simplified things or made it so that you work faster, and that it, well, that it goes faster and is more efficient.	Process acceleration Operational efficiency	AI streamlines everyday work	
Participant 5	I do not think it has affected that much. We have not come very far, I would say. I would say that we are still at step one. The only thing it really does is summarize and log. Then there is not much other impact it has on my everyday work today at least.	Surface-level integration Limited impact	Early-stage AI with restricted role effect	
Participant 6	I do not know if it has affected that much actually. I still have the same areas of responsibility. It is not like it has taken my job in any way. So I do not really think it has changed that much.	Role continuity Low displacement perception	Professional position remains largely unchanged	
Participant 7	Responsibilities in themselves, the only responsibility one actually has, is to solve the customer's problem. Of course it can be like small things on the side, that you should keep a clean desk, arrive on time to work. But I think specifically about responsibilities in themselves. The AI has really only become more efficient so that one can help more customers' problems in that errand.	Core responsibility retention Service capacity expansion	Efficiency support, but does not replace, customer responsibility	
Participant 8	It becomes that one is extra careful with checking what has been summarized, for example. That one does not, as I said then, so that it does not say performed if one has maybe only informed. Because there is such a big difference between doing something and only informing.	Accountability for AI output Risk-sensitive verification	Human oversight remains essential	
Participant 10	The little I have used the AI in the areas where it is possible then it has still affected me in my professional role in such a way that the meetings become more efficient. I do not need to bring forward a conditions appendix and read through it in order to see where I find the information, but I ask my question in the AI tool and get an answer fairly immediately.	Knowledge retrieval support Professional enablement	AI strengthens the professional role through faster information access	

Participant 1	There’s really no difference. It’s just an additional task, but not significant enough to affect motivation.	Motivation Naturality Marginal burden	Added task with a minimal motivation effect	AI’s motivational value emerges primarily through reduced routines, strain, stronger customer focus, and improved work quality
Participant 2	I don't necessarily say that it motivates me more, but it takes away a thing that could be demotivating when it comes to what's happened before in the errands like that.	Demotivation Reduction Task relief	AI removes frustration element of work	
Participant 3	My motivation has improved significantly after AI was introduced. As I mentioned, I’ve started setting higher goals for myself because the daily work has become easier. So personal development and goal-setting have improved.	Development Motivation Goal intensification	AI enables growth-oriented motivation	
Participant 4	Yes, it has made my engagement increase in a way, and I become more satisfied because I may have time to do more things.	Enhance engagement Time enabled Satisfaction	Greater time flexibility increases engagement	
Participant 5	Right now it is mainly the summary. That it captures all the summary. You can be more present in the customer meeting. You can focus more on what the customer says and be more helpful.	Customer presence Relation focus	AI strengthens customer-centered work	
Participant 6	But it is a bit like you say, first and foremost, with the engagement, that one becomes more engaged in the customer and the customer’s needs, and that one focuses more on how can I help the customer, what can I offer the customer and make easier for them with things that they maybe do not know that they need help with, those kinds of things	Service engagement Needs orientation	Motivation shift towards customer support	

Participant 7	I cannot write, so that is very nice. But then my motivation in itself, yes, I would say it is the same, but it is just that one does not have to think about that particular part	Stable motivation Conjunctive relief	Task relief without motivation change	
Participant 8	Yes, it has motivated me to give out correct information to customers, because it will write down regardless of whether one has said the right or the incorrect thing. So that also means that the quality of one's job actually becomes better, because one must be careful with everything.	Accuracy Motivation Quality accountability	AI reinforces careful and correct performance	
Participant 9	One also has time to prepare a little for the next one, instead of like taking one's time to log and write, so that there is a common thread and so that everything becomes correct. Then I can also kind of reflect a little after the meeting and then look a little at what one did well, if one did something a little less well. So yes, I think that it raises motivation.	Reflective improvement Preparation capacity	AI creates space for reflection and improvement	
Participant 10	But work motivation connected to using an AI tool, yes, it is positive. Because you get there faster. You can deliver faster. You can be more efficient. Yes. So it is really only positive motivation in that errand. Increased motivation.	Performance motivation Efficiency Drive	Speed and efficiency enhance motivation	
Participant 1	Hard to say, but in general, it seems like most people believe AI will take over sooner or later.	Replacement anticipation	Future job uncertainty and reliability concern	AI adoption creates future-oriented uncertainty around job security, data protection, and the continued need for human judgment
Participant 1	One issue is that it sometimes writes incorrectly. We have something called KMM, customer satisfaction measurement. In several errands , the AI has completely misunderstood what the customer is saying and replaces the customer's words with either words that don't exist or words that mean something entirely different.	Output misinterpretation		
Participant 2	I would say data security is a big thing that probably that's also one thing that would probably make it a bit slower when it comes to banking if you compare it to other	Data security anxiety	Security and role redundancy concerns	

	customer support, because it's so much sensitive information.			
Participant 2	Yeah, so that's the main thing, information security. Also, of course, for the job itself, if the AI gets good enough and people get comfortable enough to use it a lot, you won't really need that many customer support workers.	Workforce reduction		
Participant 4	No, it can write names, medical conditions, addresses.	Sensitive-data exposure	Privacy exposure and automation threat	
Participant 4	On the negative side, it can lead to us humans no longer being needed since AI can answer and summarize everything. There already exists self-service when you call in, where you can speak to a robot and resolve matters. And that means that in the end, if it continues in this direction, people might lose their jobs because we are not needed. Because, well, AI robots and similar things take over.	Human redundancy fear		
Participant 5	The risk for me is that AI develops very fast, that you do not have your job left. That is probably the biggest risk for someone working in customer service.	Accelerated displacement risk	Employment anxiety and security risk	
Participant 5	Yes, it is a bit that something might go wrong, that some personal data and sensitive information leaks. That is probably the biggest danger, I would say. This is a profession where it must be very secure. So it must not happen that something like that goes wrong.	Personal-data leakage risk		
Participant 6	Well it is that I do not think that it suits all customers. One already knows now. We have some small chatbot that one can write with. I have never heard anyone say anything positive about it. So I am a little uncertain actually about how it will be perceived by the customer.	Customer acceptance uncertainty	Customer trust and inappropriate action risk	
Participant 6	Well, partly that one shares information that one maybe cannot share. But then one also knows that AI does not always have 100% correct answers. So if one asks AI something and then receives an answer that one thinks is correct, then it can go very wrong that one does something that one is not allowed to do or like that. So that is a risk, absolutely.	Compliance risk		

Participant 8	Then we do not follow the bank rules, I mean. And not our way of working either, our routines. We have a way to handle for example people with protected personal data. And these are things that I think AI does not perceive.	Procedural misalignment	Rule noncompliance and reduced human need	
Participant 8	One maybe will not have any job left, because it will not be needed as much.	Partial displacement		
Participant 9	I think that it will replace very many things. As said, I think that those who sit with the administrative stuff sit a little loosely. But for customer service it is still very personal.	Task-based displacement	Selective replacement and societal concern	
Participant 9	That can probably be included but I have never experienced it. I do not talk to that many protected personal data customers via the phone. But it can probably happen. That is probably it. And then one always has to be careful to read through every AI summary, even if one thinks that it is a simple one one still has to stand for what it has written.	Ethical unease		
		Potential confidentiality risk		
Participant 10	So far positively. One never knows how it will look further ahead. If one will completely be replaced by an AI. Regardless of in what form the AI will be, meaning whether it will be digital or whether there will sit a robot with AI characteristics like. So I do not think there are any limits to it. I think that it can develop very much and replace certain professional roles.	Open-ended replacement uncertainty	Long-term uncertainty and future security vulnerability	
Participant 10	Intrusion, leakage. Yes, exactly. Meaning leakage of information, absolutely but then it feels like then it would need to have access to sensitive tools and databases within the work in order to do that and be able to make its own decisions. That feels a little far ahead. But it is definitely, I definitely think that it can be a risk, yes.	Data-intrusion risk		